

BUSINESS MENTOR · PREPARED 3 OCTOBER 2026

100 New Business Ideas for India

Proven abroad, rare in India, explained in plain words. For a first-time founder with ₹3 lakh who sells and makes Reels while partners do the work.

Every idea here already works and makes money in another country, and is rare or missing in India. None of them repeats the earlier list. Each one is explained on its own card in plain words.

How to read each card

- **In one line:** what the business is.
- **What's missing in India today:** the everyday problem it solves.
- **How it works:** what the customer does, what you do, and who does the actual work. In every idea, a partner, freelancer or supplier does the hands-on work while you find customers and run things.
- **Who pays and how much:** the customer and a rough price.
- **Proof it works abroad:** a real company doing it, with a link.
- **Who does this in India now:** the Indian businesses we found doing the same thing.
- **To start:** roughly how much money you need, how many weeks until the first paying customer, and the biggest risk.

Three honest notes

1. **The competitor checks are quick web searches.** Small businesses that only sell on Instagram don't show up in them. Before you choose an idea, spend half a day searching Instagram, Justdial and Google Maps in your own city.
2. **Every price and cost marked "about" is an estimate,** not a quote from a supplier.
3. A few "proof abroad" lines are marked "(not checked)" because we could not open a source for them.

My 10 picks for you

These suit someone who is good at selling and making Reels, wants partners to do the work, has ₹3 lakh, and wants to start by December.

1. **A printed family newspaper for grandparents, every month (#59).** Children abroad pay every month. No one does it in India, and it costs about ₹60,000 to start. It's the same feeling as the voice-note book you liked.
2. **Flight companions for parents flying alone to visit their children abroad (#61).** It solves a real fear, and December is peak travel season. NRI children pay.
3. **Head-lice removal at home for children (#1).** Every parent knows the problem, no one offers the service, it costs about ₹50,000 to start, and it makes very shareable Reels.
4. **Real-grass toilet patches for dogs in flats (#19).** Owners pay every month, and no one does it in India.
5. **Film cameras on every table at weddings (#34).** It's wedding season now, it costs under ₹1 lakh, and couples love the photos.
6. **Café passport: one drink at 15 independent cafés (#29).** It's cheap to start and made for Instagram, and cafés get new customers for free.
7. **Picture books read aloud in a grandparent's own voice (#60).** An emotional gift for NRI families and for Christmas.
8. **Exam-week care boxes for students in hostels (#33).** Parents pay, and board and college exams come in February and March.

9. **Job-offer negotiation help, paid only if your offer goes up (#40).** It's easy to sell because the customer pays nothing unless they gain. You would partner with ex-recruiters.
10. **Hot tubs delivered for winter house parties (#81).** Best in Delhi NCR and other cold cities. A December launch fits, and the Reels sell themselves.

Tell me which ideas you like, even just their numbers. I'll then check competition in your city and write a step-by-step plan for the one you choose.

Health, wellness and beauty

1 Head-lice removal at home for children

Trained women visit homes and comb out head lice and their eggs, without harsh chemicals.

What's missing in India today: Lice are common in school children, especially girls with long hair, and they spread to the whole family. Parents spend hours combing or buy strong lotions, because no one offers a discreet service that does the job for them.

How it works:

1. A parent books a visit on WhatsApp, often after a note from school.
2. You recruit women (for example, salon helpers or nannies) and train them to comb hair section by section with fine metal lice combs and conditioner.
3. Your partner arrives with a plain-looking kit, checks every family member, and combs out the lice and eggs in about 1–2 hours.
4. You sell a follow-up check 7–10 days later, and offer "lice check days" to schools and girls' hostels.

Who pays and how much: Parents in big cities; about ₹1,500–2,500 per child per visit, plus about ₹800 for the follow-up check.

Proof it works abroad: Lice Clinics of America, USA: had done 750,000 head-lice treatments and had 179 clinics in 17 countries by 2021 ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹50,000 (combs, training, kits, Reels ads). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying family. Main risk: parents feel embarrassed to book, so everything must look discreet. (The US chain uses an approved heated-air machine; you would use combing only and never promise a "cure".)

2 Stretch coaches who come to your home

A trained coach visits and gently moves your body through deep stretches while you lie on a mat.

What's missing in India today: Desk workers, older adults and weekend players feel stiff, but their only options are a massage, a physiotherapist (for injuries) or a yoga class where they stretch themselves. No one sells one-on-one sessions where someone else stretches you.

How it works:

1. The customer books a 45-minute session or a pack of 8.
2. You hire certified fitness trainers or yoga teachers and pay for a short course in assisted stretching.
3. Your partner brings a mat and straps, fills in a health form with the customer, and stretches their legs, hips, back and shoulders.
4. You handle bookings, reminders and packs, and send anyone with pain or an injury to a doctor instead.

Who pays and how much: Office workers aged 30–60, golfers, runners, and older parents (often paid for by their children); about ₹1,200–1,800 per session, or about ₹9,000 for 8.

Proof it works abroad: StretchLab, USA: became the first assisted-stretching chain to reach 500 studios in North America, in 2024 ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No dedicated stretching service found. Nearest: Tattva Spa sells a "yoga stretch therapy" spa treatment ([link](#)), and physiotherapy clinics stretch patients as part of treatment.

To start: About ₹60,000 (course for 2–3 coaches, mats, straps, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: a customer gets hurt, so coaches need proper training and a health form before every first session.

3

Workout classes for new mothers, with their babies

Group exercise classes where new mothers work out while their babies sit in prams or carriers beside them.

What's missing in India today: After a baby, many mothers want to exercise and meet other mothers but cannot leave the baby at home. Gyms don't allow babies, and postnatal classes here are mostly yoga sessions where the baby stays home.

How it works:

1. A mother joins a monthly plan once her doctor says she can exercise (usually 6 or more weeks after birth).
2. You find morning slots in housing-society clubhouses, malls before opening time, or shaded parks.
3. Your partner, a certified pregnancy and after-birth fitness trainer, runs a 45–60 minute class of brisk walking, squats and tummy work, with songs for the babies.
4. You run the mothers' WhatsApp group, sell monthly plans, and add coffee meet-ups after class.

Who pays and how much: Mothers of babies aged about 2 months to 2 years; about ₹3,000–4,000 a month for 3 classes a week, or about ₹500 for a single class.

Proof it works abroad: FIT4MOM (Stroller Strides), USA: had 221 locations open, according to its 2024 franchise papers ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No pram or baby-carrier workout classes found. Nearest: Birth N Beyond Yoga in Mumbai runs postnatal exercise sessions without babies ([link](#)).

To start: About ₹40,000 (trainer fees for a trial month, venue, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: heat and pollution, so you need indoor clubhouse slots as a back-up.

4

Stylish reusable earplugs for noisy Indian cities

Soft, good-looking reusable earplugs that turn down loud noise but still let you hear voices and music.

What's missing in India today: Honking, wedding bands, DJ trucks, building work and festival crackers are very loud, and many people sleep badly because of noise. Most people only know cheap foam plugs from chemists, which look odd and block everything.

How it works:

1. You find a factory (in China or India) that makes silicone earplugs and have it make them in your colours and case, under your brand.
2. You sell online with Reels about everyday noise: sleeping, concerts, weddings, metro rides, focusing at work.
3. Customers buy one pair, or a set (one for sleep, one for events).
4. You add sales stands at concerts, gyms and shared offices.

Who pays and how much: City people aged 18–45: concert-goers, light sleepers, night-shift workers, parents at weddings; about ₹999–1,599 a pair.

Proof it works abroad: Loop Earplugs, Belgium: sales grew to €126.5 million in 2023 and €190 million in 2024 ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found. Loop's own earplugs reach India only through import websites such as Ubuy ([link](#)).

To start: About ₹1.5–2 lakh (first batch of about 1,000 pairs, samples, packaging, ads). About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: Loop could launch properly in India and outspend you.

5 Self-warming steam eye masks

Use-once eye masks that gently warm up when you open them, giving 20 minutes of relaxing heat.

What's missing in India today: Office workers and students stare at screens all day, and many sleep badly. In Japan these masks are an everyday habit, but in India they are only sold as random foreign imports.

How it works:

1. You order the masks from a factory in China or Japan that already makes them, printed with your brand and scents (lavender, rose, unscented).
2. You sell boxes online with Reels: "after work", "before sleep", "on a flight".
3. Customers buy boxes of 5 or 10, or a monthly box.
4. You pitch them as gifts, and to hotels and airport lounges.

Who pays and how much: Desk workers, students and frequent flyers; about ₹499–699 for a box of 10.

Proof it works abroad: Kao MegRhythm, Japan: Kao says its steam eye mask is No. 1 by sales value in Japan's eye-care market (Intage data, 2020–2022) ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found in a quick search; only foreign packs sold by importers.

To start: About ₹1.2–1.5 lakh (first order, safety tests on the heat pads, ads). About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: the masks must never get too hot, and you must not make health claims about eyes.

6 Refillable deodorant with refills by post

Buy one smart deodorant case once, then get cheaper refills delivered every two months.

What's missing in India today: Every underarm deodorant in Indian shops comes in a plastic bottle or can that goes in the bin when empty. There is almost no option to keep one good case and buy only the refill.

How it works:

1. The customer buys a starter kit: a sturdy case plus one refill.
2. A licensed cosmetics factory (a factory that makes products under your brand name) makes the refills from one of its ready recipes; a packaging supplier makes the case.
3. You post refills every 2 months, and customers can pause or skip any time.
4. You add new scents and gift sets to keep people buying.

Who pays and how much: City people aged 20–40 who want less plastic; about ₹799 for the case and first refill, then about ₹249–299 per refill.

Proof it works abroad: Wild, UK: Unilever bought it in 2025, in a deal reported to value it at about £230 million ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: One found: Bare Necessities, with Without, launched what it calls India's first refillable natural roll-on deodorant ([link](#)).

To start: About ₹2–2.5 lakh (first factory batch, cases, licence and labels, ads). About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: the case must feel premium but stay cheap, and the formula must work in Indian heat.

7

Gel nail stickers that set under a small lamp

Soft gel nail stickers you press on at home and harden under a small lamp, like salon gel nails.

What's missing in India today: A gel manicure at a salon costs about ₹1,000–2,000 and takes an hour. The nail stickers sold here are thin and peel off within days.

How it works:

1. You order designs from a factory that makes "semi-cured" gel strips (mostly in Korea and China), picking colours for weddings, festivals and office wear.
2. You sell a starter kit (strips plus a small lamp) and refill packs online.
3. Customers put them on in about 15 minutes and wear them for up to about two weeks.
4. You launch new designs every month, with Reels showing the before and after.

Who pays and how much: Women aged 18–40 who like gel nails but not the salon time or price; about ₹1,499 for a starter kit with lamp, then about ₹599–799 a pack.

Proof it works abroad: Refinery29 UK reports that these strips "are replacing salon gels", names UK sellers MoYou London, Maniko and Hello Nails, and says they last around 14 days ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹1.5–2 lakh (first designs, lamps, packaging, ads). About 10–12 weeks. Main risk: imported nail products may need a cosmetics import registration that can take 3 months or more, so check this first or find a maker in India.

8

Nordic pole walking groups for people over 45

Guided group walks using special walking poles, which turn a normal walk into a full-body workout.

What's missing in India today: Millions of people over 45 walk in parks every morning, but plain walking gets boring and works mostly the legs. Nordic walking, popular in Germany and the UK, is almost unknown here.

How it works:

1. Customers sign up for a 4-week beginners' course, then a monthly walking group.
2. You buy a set of poles and get 2–3 fitness trainers qualified as Nordic walking instructors.
3. Your partner leads 45-minute walks in big parks 3 mornings a week and teaches the technique.
4. You sell plans and poles, and run a monthly "walk and breakfast" meet-up.

Who pays and how much: Men and women aged about 45–70; about ₹1,500 for the 4-week course, then about ₹1,500–2,000 a month.

Proof it works abroad: Nordic Walking UK (now WALX), UK: brought Nordic walking to the UK in 2004, has trained thousands of instructors, and says it has helped over half a million people become more active ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹80,000 (about 30 pairs of poles, instructor training, ads). About 4–5 weeks. Main risk: people may find the poles odd at first, so Reels must show how good the workout feels.

9

Sweat-proof undershirts for office men

Cotton undershirts with a hidden sweat-blocking layer under the arms, so sweat never reaches the shirt.

What's missing in India today: In humid cities, men get sweat patches and yellow stains on office shirts by late morning. Indian undershirts are plain vests that simply soak through.

How it works:

1. You find a garment factory in Tiruppur or Bengaluru to make undershirts with a sewn-in sweat-blocking underarm panel, to your design.
2. You test samples on hot commutes and post "sweat test" Reels.
3. Customers buy packs of 3 online; later you add collar liners that stop collar stains.
4. You sell bulk packs to grooms' families and to companies whose staff wear formal uniforms.

Who pays and how much: Office men, sales staff, grooms; about ₹2,499–2,999 for a pack of 3.

Proof it works abroad: Thompson Tee, USA: started with \$20,000 of the founders' money and had sold 2 million sweat-proof undershirts by 2022 ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found in a quick search. US brands such as Ejis are only available through import sites like Ubuy ([Ubuy](#)).

To start: About ₹1.5–2 lakh (samples, fabric tests, first 600 pieces, ads). About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: getting the sweat panel right, because a bad batch means many returns.

10

Fan-cooled jackets for outdoor workers

Light jackets with two small battery fans that blow air under the cloth to keep workers cool.

What's missing in India today: Construction workers, delivery riders, traffic police and factory staff work in 40°C-plus heat. Their employers give them water and caps, but little else.

How it works:

1. You import fan jackets and vests from a factory (mostly in China or Japan), with the buyer's logo if they want.
2. You sell to companies: builders, delivery firms, factories, event companies and city councils.
3. You run a free one-week trial on a work site so workers and managers feel the difference.
4. You sell spare batteries and fans later.

Who pays and how much: Companies buying for their workers; about ₹5,000–8,000 per jacket with battery.

Proof it works abroad: Kuchofuku (the name means "air-conditioned clothes"), Japan: has made fan-fitted work clothes for about 35 years and sells suits, vests and half-sleeve versions through Amazon and Rakuten ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No consumer brand found. Generic fan jackets (about ₹2,300) and industrial cooling vests (Inuteq, Surakshit) are sold on IndiaMART ([IndiaMART](#)).

To start: About ₹2 lakh (samples, about 30 jackets for trials, battery safety checks). About 8–12 weeks to the first company order. Main risk: lithium batteries may need Indian safety approval (BIS) before import, and sales are seasonal, so sell from January for the summer.

11

Extra-large swim caps and chlorine wash for long hair

Roomy swim caps made for long, thick or curly hair, plus a wash that removes pool chlorine.

What's missing in India today: Many Indian girls and women have long, thick hair that normal swim caps can't hold. Their hair comes out dry and smelling of chlorine, so many give up swimming.

How it works:

1. A silicone factory makes extra-large caps in your colours; a licensed cosmetics factory makes a chlorine-removing shampoo and body wash from a ready recipe.
2. You sell a "swim kit" online and through swimming academies and school swim camps.
3. Swim coaches earn a small fee for every kit their students buy.
4. You make Reels on "how to swim without wrecking your hair".

Who pays and how much: Parents of girls in swim classes, and women who swim; about ₹999 for a cap, or about ₹1,799 for the cap-and-wash kit.

Proof it works abroad: Soul Cap, UK: two friends started it to make an extra-large cap for voluminous hair; it now sells swimwear and goggles too, and has pledged £100,000 to grassroots swimming ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: Long-hair swim caps are already sold by Speedo, Airavat and Viva ([Kibi Sports](#)), but no one sells a cap-plus-hair-care kit made for long Indian hair.

To start: About ₹1–1.5 lakh. About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: swimming peaks in April–June, so use the winter to sign up academies.

12

Makeup made for men

Simple makeup for men, like concealer sticks and tinted moisturiser, that hides dark circles and marks in seconds.

What's missing in India today: Many men worry about dark circles, pimple marks and uneven skin before weddings, dates and video calls. Makeup is sold and shown only for women, with no guidance for men.

How it works:

1. A licensed cosmetics factory makes 2–3 products from its ready recipes, in shades that suit Indian skin.
2. You design plain, no-fuss packaging and short Reels like "30-second fix before a meeting".
3. Customers buy online, and you match shades on WhatsApp (they send a photo, you suggest a shade).
4. You sell groom kits through wedding planners and men's salons.

Who pays and how much: Men aged 20–40, and grooms; about ₹599–899 per product, or about ₹1,999 for a groom kit.

Proof it works abroad: War Paint for Men, UK: sells "award-winning makeup for men" in eight shades, from fair to very deep ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: 1: Yaan Man, which calls itself India's first men's makeup brand and appeared on Shark Tank India ([NE Now](#)).

To start: About ₹2–2.5 lakh. About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: men feel shy buying "makeup", so the brand must talk about quick fixes.

13

Back-hair shaver for men

A long-handled razor that lets a man shave his own back without anyone's help.

What's missing in India today: Many men have back hair and feel shy at pools, beaches and gyms. Waxing hurts and means a parlour visit, and no one here sells a simple tool to do it yourself.

How it works:

1. You get a factory (mostly in China) to make a back shaver with replaceable blades, under your brand.
2. You sell online with funny, honest Reels about back hair.
3. Customers buy the shaver and come back for blade refills.
4. You add a body trimmer and an after-shave lotion later.

Who pays and how much: Men aged 20–45; about ₹1,499 for the shaver and about ₹399 for refill blades.

Proof it works abroad: BakBlade, USA: sells do-it-yourself back shavers for \$59.95–79.95, plus refill blades (sales not checked) ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found. Only generic listings and imported brands such as BakBlade and Mangroomer ([IndiaMART](#)).

To start: About ₹1–1.5 lakh. About 8–10 weeks. Main risk: few repeat buyers, so refills must be good value.

14

Recovery boxes for new mothers after birth

A ready box with everything a mother needs for her body in the first weeks after giving birth.

What's missing in India today: Hospitals send mothers home with little advice. Families rush to chemists for pads, cooling packs and nursing items, and often buy the wrong things.

How it works:

1. You buy items from Indian suppliers: maternity pads, disposable briefs, a squeeze bottle for gentle washing, cooling pads, nipple cream, a belly band and a simple printed guide.
2. You pack them in a gift-ready box.
3. Mothers buy it before the delivery, or friends buy it as a baby-shower gift.
4. You sell through baby-shower planners, pregnancy classes and maternity-clothing shops.

Who pays and how much: Expecting mothers, their families and friends; about ₹2,499–3,499 per box.

Proof it works abroad: Frida, USA: best known for baby products, it now sells a full "delivery recovery" range for new mothers (sales not checked) ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: 1: Juno Mom sells a postpartum kit on Smytten ([Smytten](#)).

To start: About ₹1–1.5 lakh. About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: hospitals may already hand out some items, so the box must feel like a thoughtful gift, not a pile of pads.

15

Forest bathing walks

Slow, quiet, guided walks in city forests where you notice the trees, sounds and smells.

What's missing in India today: City people are stressed and on their phones all day. Nature walks here are about fitness or birdwatching; slow, guided "forest bathing", common in Japan, is rare.

How it works:

1. Customers book a 2-hour walk on a weekend morning, alone or as a team.
2. Your partner, a guide trained in forest bathing (for example, a yoga teacher or naturalist), leads 10–15 people through simple prompts: listen, touch the bark, sit quietly.
3. The walk ends with herbal tea and a short chat.
4. You sell private walks to companies as a calm team outing.

Who pays and how much: Office workers aged 25–50, and companies; about ₹1,200–1,500 per person, or about ₹25,000 for a private company walk.

Proof it works abroad: Association of Nature and Forest Therapy (ANFT), USA: has trained forest-bathing guides for over a decade and runs trainings in Japan, Hong Kong, Thailand and Costa Rica ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: 2–3: luxury resorts (Oberoi Sukhvilas, Pugdundee Safaris) offer it at their properties, and Bengaluru has seen one-off walks in Cubbon Park ([SheThePeople](#)). No regular city walks found.

To start: About ₹50,000 (guide training or fees, park permissions, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: it is new and slow, so Reels must show why it feels good; never call it "therapy".

16

Walking football for people over 50

A gentle version of football where nobody is allowed to run, so people over 50 can play.

What's missing in India today: Men who loved football or cricket usually stop team sports after 40 because of their knees and fitness. There are few team games built for them.

How it works:

1. You rent a 5-a-side turf on weekday mornings, when turfs are empty and cheap.
2. Your partner, a football coach, runs warm-ups and referees "no running" games.
3. Players buy monthly passes, and you add tea and breakfast afterwards.
4. You hold a friendly tournament every few months.

Who pays and how much: Men over 50 and women over 40; about ₹1,500–2,000 a month for 2 sessions a week.

Proof it works abroad: Walking Football Association, England: the game was created in 2011 for men over 50 and women over 40, and the WFA says thousands now play regularly, including people in their 70s and 80s ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No walking-football group found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹40,000 (first month's turf rent, balls, bibs, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: finding the first 20 players; start through morning walking groups and housing-society committees.

17

30-minute strength workouts for women over 40

Women-only, 30-minute group workouts that move round simple strength stations, held in neighbourhood halls.

What's missing in India today: Many women over 40 feel out of place in big gyms full of young men. Yoga and walks are easy to find, but friendly strength workouts for this age group are rare.

How it works:

1. You rent a clubhouse or community hall in a large housing society for morning slots.
2. You set up 10 stations with bands, light dumbbells and steps.
3. Your partner, a certified woman trainer, starts a new 30-minute round every half hour, so women can come when it suits them.
4. You sell monthly plans and run a free "bring a friend" week each month.

Who pays and how much: Women aged about 40–65; about ₹2,000–3,000 a month.

Proof it works abroad: Curves, USA and Japan: runs 30-minute circuit workouts in 39 countries; in 2018 its Japanese operator, Koshidaka (Curves Japan), bought the international business ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No dedicated Indian programme found in a quick search; general gyms and online coaches exist.

To start: About ₹1–1.2 lakh (equipment for 10 stations, hall rent, trainer, ads). About 4–5 weeks. Main risk: women must feel stronger within the first month or they stop coming.

18

Grooming visits at home for bedridden and elderly people

A trained team visits homes to give bedridden elderly people a haircut, shave, nail trim and hair-wash.

What's missing in India today: Elderly people who cannot leave home often go months without a proper haircut or nail trim. Salon staff are not trained to handle frail people, and home nurses focus on medical care.

How it works:

1. The family (often a son or daughter abroad) books one visit or a monthly plan.
2. You train salon professionals in gentle care for elderly clients and give them a portable kit with an inflatable hair-wash basin.
3. Your partner cuts hair, shaves, trims nails and washes hair in bed, then sends the family before-and-after photos.
4. You sell monthly "grooming days" to old-age homes and senior-living communities.

Who pays and how much: Families of elderly people, often children living abroad; about ₹1,200–1,800 per visit, or about ₹4,000 a month for weekly visits.

Proof it works abroad: Japan has home-visit bathing services where a team brings a portable bathtub to bedridden people at home (not checked).

Who does this in India now: No specialist found. Urban Company does general home haircuts ([Urban Company](#)), but not trained care for bedridden people.

To start: About ₹50,000. About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: injuring a frail client, so train carefully and turn away anyone who needs medical care (for example, diabetic foot problems).

Pets, food, drinks and products

19

Real-grass toilet patches for dogs in flats

A tray of real, living grass, delivered every week or two, for flat dogs to pee on. What's missing in India today: Dogs in tall buildings often need to pee at night, in heavy rain or while their owners are at work, so owners use plastic pee pads or fake-grass mats that start to smell. Nobody in India delivers fresh, real grass on a regular schedule and takes the old patch away. How it works: 1. The owner picks a patch size and how often they want a fresh one (every week or every two weeks). 2. A partner plant nursery grows grass in light coconut-fibre trays, with no soil mess. 3. You deliver each fresh patch by local courier and take the used one back for composting. 4. You find customers through Reels, vets, pet shops and building WhatsApp groups. Who pays and how much: Owners of puppies, small dogs and old dogs in flats. About ₹699–999 per patch, or about ₹2,500 a month for a fresh patch every week. Proof it works abroad: Fresh Patch, USA: sells real-grass patches (a standard patch costs \$34.95) on a plan that sends a fresh one every 1–4 weeks. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Only imported fake-grass mats are sold online (for example on Ubuy). To start: About ₹1,00,000 (trial batches with a nursery, trays, delivery, first ads, reserve). About 4–5 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: grass browning or smelling in hot weather, and delivery costs eating the profit.

20

Borrow-a-dog club for people who can't own one

A club that matches busy dog owners with nearby dog lovers who walk their dogs for free. What's missing in India today: Many young people in rented flats or hostels love dogs but are not allowed to keep one, while many owners want extra walks and company for their dog without paying a walker every day. Paid dog-walking services exist, but no trusted club links these two groups. How it works: 1. Owners and dog lovers in one neighbourhood join through a simple form, with ID checks. 2. You match them and set up a first "meet the dog" visit in a park. 3. The borrower walks the dog or spends an afternoon with it; no money passes between them. 4. Both sides pay you a yearly fee, and you run monthly park meet-ups to keep the club lively. Who pays and how much: Dog owners pay about ₹1,999 a year; borrowers pay about ₹499 a year. Later, pet brands can pay to sponsor meet-ups. Proof it works abroad: BorrowMyDoggy, UK: dog owners pay £49 a year and borrowers £10 a year to join and find each other. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No dog-borrowing club found. Sploot and others sell paid dog walking, which is a different service. To start: About ₹60,000 (ID checks, a simple website, meet-up costs, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: safety and trust, such as a dog getting lost or biting someone, so you need strict checks and clear rules.

21

First-aid classes for pet owners

Half-day classes, taught by vets, where pet owners learn what to do if their pet chokes, bleeds or overheats. What's missing in India today: When a dog gets heatstroke in May, swallows a bone or panics during Diwali crackers, most owners freeze and lose precious minutes. First-aid courses for humans are common, but classes for ordinary pet owners are very rare. How it works: 1. You book a vet or vet nurse as the trainer, and a pet-friendly café or clinic hall as the venue. 2. Owners book a 3–4 hour Saturday class and practise on dog-shaped training dummies. 3. Everyone goes home with a printed emergency card and a pet first-aid kit that you buy from suppliers. 4. You also sell private classes to housing societies, pet hostels, groomers and dog-walking firms for their staff. Who pays and how much: Pet owners pay about ₹1,499–2,499 a seat. Pet businesses pay about ₹15,000–25,000 to train a batch of staff. Proof it works abroad: IndyVet, USA: runs a 4-hour animal first-aid and CPR class for pet owners at \$50 a person, with a manual and hands-on practice. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: VOSD in Bengaluru ran a one-day workshop at ₹2,999 for 15 people, aimed mainly at rescuers and street-dog feeders. No regular classes for pet owners were found in other cities. To start: About ₹70,000 (two training dummies, kits, vet fees for the first classes, venue, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: finding vets who teach well and can give up their Saturdays.

22

Dog handlers for weddings

A trained handler brings your dog to your wedding, keeps it calm and safe, then takes it home. What's missing in India today: More couples want their dog in the pre-wedding shoot or the varmala photos, but weddings are loud, with dhol, crackers and crowds, and every relative is busy. No one offers a booked service that looks after the dog for the day. How it works: 1. The couple books a package: a visit to meet the dog beforehand, pick-up, 4–6 hours of care at the venue, and drop-off. 2. Your partner, a trained pet sitter or dog trainer, keeps the dog in a quiet room, walks it and brings it out for photos and the big moment. 3. You find couples through wedding planners, photographers and Reels of dogs at weddings. 4. Add-ons include a second dog, outfits from a partner tailor, or overnight care during a three-day wedding. Who pays and how much: Couples with dogs, mostly in big cities. About ₹7,500–15,000 per wedding day. Proof it works abroad: All Paws Weddings, UK: full-day dog care at weddings starts at £379, with £100 for each extra dog. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Some wedding planners arrange pet grooming or transport as a side favour. To start: About ₹50,000 (paying and briefing 2–3 handlers, travel crates, first-aid kits, ads). About 3–5 weeks, and the wedding season is already on. Main risk: a frightened dog getting hurt or running off at a crowded venue.

23

Comfort products for old dogs and cats

An online shop and home set-up service for ageing pets: soft beds, ramps, non-slip mats, lifting belts. What's missing in India today: Pets now live longer, and many dogs over 10 struggle with stairs, slippery floors and weak back legs. Owners find odd items on Amazon, but no shop explains what an old pet needs or comes to set up the home. How it works: 1. The owner fills a short form or does a video call about the pet's age and problems. 2. You suggest a kit (bed, ramp, mats, harness) sourced from Indian makers of foam beds, mats and harnesses. 3. A delivery partner drops it off, and for bigger homes a helper lays the mats and fixes the ramp. 4. Vets refer old pets to you, and you post "golden oldies" Reels. Who pays and how much: Owners of dogs and cats aged 8 or more. Kits about ₹2,499–5,999; single items about ₹499–2,999. Proof it works abroad: Walkin' Pets, USA: has sold wheelchairs, harnesses and support products for old and disabled pets since 2001. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: Earlier research for this project found no shop focused on old pets, only charity homes for old dogs (CUPA and VOSD). Big pet stores such as HUFT and Supertails may sell some items (not checked). To start: About ₹1,20,000 (first stock, photos, ads, reserve). About 4–5 weeks. Main risk: unsold stock, and a smaller audience than puppy owners.

24

Frozen croissants and breads you bake at home

A box of frozen croissants and breads from good bakeries that you bake fresh at home in minutes. What's missing in India today: Good croissants and sourdough are sold in only a few cafés, and they go stale within a day. Many homes now have an oven (OTG) or air fryer, but you cannot buy café-quality frozen pastries to bake at home. How it works: 1. You partner with 1–2 good bakeries that already make frozen dough for cafés and hotels. 2. Customers order a box (for example 12 croissants, 6 chocolate croissants and 2 sourdough loaves) on WhatsApp or a simple website. 3. You deliver it frozen within the city in insulated boxes with ice packs. 4. Customers keep it in the freezer and bake a few on a lazy Sunday morning. Who pays and how much: Families and couples who love café breakfasts. About ₹1,499–2,499 a box, with a monthly plan. Proof it works abroad: Wildgrain, USA: a bake-from-frozen box of breads and pastries made by about 50 small bakeries, with over 100,000 subscribers and over \$31 million a year in revenue. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No home box found. Frozen croissants are sold only in bulk to cafés and hotels, for example by Delta Nutrition and Hot Cakes on IndiaMART. To start: About ₹1,20,000 (a deep freezer, insulated boxes, ice packs, the ₹100 FSSAI food registration, first ads, reserve). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: keeping everything frozen on the way in a hot city.

25

A box of snacks from a different Indian state every month

Each month, a box of famous snacks and sweets from one Indian state, with their stories. What's missing in India today: Someone in Bengaluru rarely tastes real Bikaneri bhujia, Goan bebinca or Assamese pitha unless a friend brings some back from a trip. Snacks are sold everywhere, but nobody puts together a fun "travel India by snack" box each month. How it works: 1. Each month you choose one state and buy 8–10 packed snacks from well-known local makers who already hold food licences. 2. You pack them with a printed card telling the story of each snack. 3. Customers sign up monthly, or gift 3 or 6 months, and you ship by courier. 4. You sell with "unboxing Nagaland" style Reels to snack lovers, students and gift buyers, and later to NRI families. Who pays and how much: Snack lovers and people buying gifts. About ₹999–1,499 a box. Proof it works abroad: Universal Yums, USA: sends snacks from a different country each month, and has over 100,000 active subscribers and over 10 million boxes sold. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: Only older general snack boxes were found: The Namkeen Club (Mumbai, 2018) and TopMunch (2017). Whether they still run is unknown. To start: About ₹1,00,000 (the first 100 boxes, packaging, printing, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: short shelf life and breakage, and people cancelling after 2–3 months.

26

Freeze-dried sweets

Sweets and gummies freeze-dried so they puff up, turn crunchy and look amazing on camera. What's missing in India today: Freeze-dried sweets are a huge social-media trend abroad, but Indian shops do not sell them. Indian factories already freeze-dry fruit, so making sweets this way is possible here. How it works: 1. You find an Indian factory that already freeze-dries fruit and ask it to do small batches of gummies, marshmallows and a few Indian sweets. 2. The factory packs them in sealed pouches and jars under your brand name. 3. You sell online and at flea markets, college fests and party shops, with Reels of the loud crunch. 4. Later you add gift jars for birthdays and return gifts. Who pays and how much: Teenagers, young adults, and parents buying party favours. About ₹249–399 a pouch. Proof it works abroad: Sow Good, USA: a freeze-dried sweets brand that made over 7.5 million units in one quarter of 2024 and was heading for 10,000+ stores. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No freeze-dried sweets brand found. Freeze Fusion Foods (Mumbai) and IndiaMART sellers offer freeze-dried fruit and meals, not sweets. To start: About ₹1,50,000 (trial batches, packaging, food registration, ads, reserve). About 5–7 weeks. Main risk: finding a factory that will do small batches, and damp air making the sweets go soft.

27

Fortune cookies with your own messages

Crisp fortune cookies with your own messages inside, for weddings, proposals, birthdays and parties. What's missing in India today: People want small personal touches at weddings and parties, yet guests get the same chocolates and dry-fruit boxes everywhere. Fortune cookies with custom messages are almost impossible to order in India. How it works: 1. A partner bakery bakes the cookies and you supply the printed message slips. 2. Customers order 50 or more online and type up to five messages, such as "Will you marry me?", a wedding hashtag or a baby announcement. 3. You wrap each cookie, pack them in branded boxes and deliver. 4. You sell through wedding planners and gift shops, with Reels of proposal reveals. Who pays and how much: Couples, party hosts and companies planning events. About ₹40–70 a cookie, with a minimum order of 50. Proof it works abroad: Fancy Fortune Cookies, USA: has made gourmet fortune cookies since at least 1988, and custom-message cookies start at \$0.70 each for 50. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Some home bakers may make them on request. To start: About ₹60,000 (trial batches with a bakery, a printer for slips, packaging, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: cookies breaking on the way, and the bakery's quality changing from batch to batch.

28

Clear party ice delivered to homes

Big, crystal-clear ice cubes and balls, like those in fancy bars, delivered for house parties. What's missing in India today: Ice made at home is cloudy, melts fast and is never enough for a party. Good bars now use clear ice, but people hosting at home still buy small bags of cloudy cubes. How it works: 1. You partner with a maker of clear ice, which freezes big blocks and cuts them into large cubes and balls. 2. Hosts order on WhatsApp a day ahead: party packs of clear cubes, balls and crushed ice, with a cool box on loan. 3. You deliver on Friday and Saturday evenings in insulated boxes. 4. Later you add ice stamped with a name or logo for birthdays and weddings. Who pays and how much: People who host house parties or have a home bar, and small event hosts. About ₹499–1,499 a party pack. Proof it works abroad: Clear-ice makers that sell big cubes to bars and home drinkers are common in the USA, such as Hundredweight Ice (not checked). Who does this in India now: JUSTice sells clear ice to bars, weddings and events. Fresh Ice sells small packs of clear cubes on Swiggy Instamart at ₹75 a kilo. No one was found selling party packs of big cubes and balls to homes. To start: About ₹80,000 (a deep freezer, cool boxes, packaging, ads). About 3 weeks. Main risk: melting on the way and thin profit, because the ice maker controls your cost.

29

Café passport: one drink at 15 independent cafés

A printed passport, bought once, that includes one drink at each of 10–20 independent cafés. What's missing in India today: Every big city has hundreds of new small cafés, but people keep going back to the same few. Small cafés cannot afford big ads to bring in new customers. How it works: 1. You sign up 10–20 independent cafés in one city, and each agrees to serve one drink from a short list to every passport holder. 2. You print a good-looking passport with one page per café. 3. People buy it online or at partner cafés, and each café stamps its page when it serves the drink. 4. Cafés are usually not paid, because they gain new regular customers; you keep the sales and print a new edition every 6–12 months. Who pays and how much: Coffee lovers, students, people new to the city, and gift buyers. About ₹999–1,499 a passport, which holds about ₹3,000 or more of drinks. Proof it works abroad: Indie Coffee Passport, Canada and USA: it started in Toronto and spread to Ottawa, Montréal and Vermont; in Burlington, \$12 bought one drink at each of 10 cafés. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Cafe BLR lists Bengaluru cafés online but does not include drinks. To start: About ₹50,000 (a freelance designer, printing 1,000 passports, ads). About 4–5 weeks. Main risk: cafés dropping out halfway, or complaining that passport holders come only once.

30

Roasted barley tea, the caffeine-free drink of Japan and Korea

Tea bags of roasted barley: nutty, caffeine-free, drunk hot in winter and iced in summer. What's missing in India today: Many people want less tea and coffee at night or during pregnancy but find herbal teas strange. Japanese and Korean homes drink roasted barley tea every day, but in India it is only sold as a costly import. How it works: 1. A tea-packing factory roasts Indian barley (jau) and packs it in tea bags under your brand. 2. You sell it now as a warm winter drink, and in summer as a jug of iced tea for the fridge. 3. You sell online, in Korean and Japanese grocery shops, in gyms and cafés, and through K-drama and Japan-travel fan pages. 4. You hand out free tasting cups at markets, because taste is what sells it. Who pays and how much: Health-minded young adults, K-culture fans, pregnant women, and parents who want a sugar-free drink for children. About ₹299–399 for 30 tea bags. Proof it works abroad: Barley tea makers, Japan: production of barley tea drinks hit a record 1.5 million kilolitres in 2025, more than seven times the 2005 level. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No Indian brand found. Japanese Ito En barley tea is sold as an import (₹1,400 for 54 bags on Wow Nippon). To start: About ₹1,00,000 (trial roasts, 2,000–3,000 packs, food registration, ads). About 5–6 weeks. Main risk: most Indians have never tasted it, so you must give away a lot of samples.

31

Good decaf coffee for evenings and pregnancy

A coffee brand that sells only good decaf, roasted fresh by an Indian partner roaster. What's missing in India today: Many people love coffee but cannot drink it after 4 pm, while pregnant, or because of anxiety or heart problems. Indian coffee brands focus on strong coffee, and good decaf (coffee with the caffeine removed) is hard to find. How it works: 1. You partner with an Indian roaster that can buy decaf beans and roast them under your brand. 2. You sell ground coffee, single-cup drip bags and cold-brew bags. 3. You reach pregnant women, new mothers, night-shift workers and "evening coffee" lovers through Reels and pregnancy pages on Instagram. 4. You offer a monthly plan so customers never run out. Who pays and how much: Coffee lovers who need to cut caffeine. About ₹599–799 for 250 grams. Proof it works abroad: Decadent Decaf, UK: a coffee company that has sold only decaf since 2014, with bags from £8.99. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: Earlier research for this project found no decaf-only brand. Lavazza launched one decaf in India in 2018, and some big roasters may sell a decaf option (not checked). To start: About ₹1,20,000 (first roasted batches, packaging, food registration, ads). About 5–7 weeks. Main risk: decaf beans are mostly imported, so your supply and price depend on the roaster.

32

Birthday cards handwritten and posted for you

Tell us your family's birthdays once; we post each person a handwritten card on time, every year. What's missing in India today: People forget birthdays or send a quick WhatsApp message instead. A real handwritten card feels special, but buying, writing and posting one on time is too much effort for most people. How it works: 1. The customer fills a form with names, addresses, dates and a few lines about each person. 2. Ten days before each birthday, you send a draft message on WhatsApp for them to approve or change. 3. Freelance writers with beautiful handwriting write the card, and you post it by Speed Post or courier. 4. Later you sell the same service to doctors, accountants and shops that want to send cards to their clients. Who pays and how much: Busy professionals, NRIs writing to family in India, and small businesses. About ₹199–299 a card, or about ₹1,999 a year for 10 cards. Proof it works abroad: Handwrytten, USA: uses robots holding real pens to write and post cards, and one business customer says it sends over 15,000 cards a month. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: The Indian Handwritten Letter Co. (Bengaluru, older article) and Yours Letterly write letters on request, and freelancers on Fiverr do too. No yearly birthday-card plan was found. To start: About ₹40,000 (cards, postage, writers' pay, a simple form, ads). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: people not renewing after the first year, and postal delays.

33

Exam-week care boxes for students in hostels

Parents order a box of snacks, treats and a note that reaches their child's hostel in exam week. What's missing in India today: Lakhs of students live in hostels and paying-guest rooms in Kota, Delhi, Pune, Manipal and other study towns. Parents want to show love during exams but can only send money, or home-made laddoos that arrive late or broken. How it works: 1. You put together three boxes (healthy snacks, comfort treats, and an "all-nighter" box with coffee and instant noodles) from packed brands. 2. Parents order online and add a personal note, which you print on a card. 3. You deliver to the hostel gate just before exams, timed to each college's exam dates. 4. College student clubs share your link with parents and earn a small cut, the same way US colleges run it. Who pays and how much: Parents of college and coaching-centre students. About ₹799–1,999 a box. Proof it works abroad: University of Wisconsin–Madison alumni association, USA: sold parents exam-week care packages at \$15.45–30.95 and expected 400–500 orders in one term (older article). ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. To start: About ₹70,000 (stock for the first 100 boxes, packaging, ads aimed at parents). About 3–4 weeks, and end-of-term exams fall in November–December. Main risk: hostels refusing deliveries, and exam dates differing from college to college.

34

Film cameras on every table at weddings

Disposable film cameras on wedding tables; we develop the film and send the couple every guest photo. What's missing in India today: Couples pay a lot for photographers but miss the fun, candid shots that guests take. Film cameras are back in fashion with young people, but no one in India offers a ready service that includes developing and scanning. How it works: 1. The couple books a pack of 10, 20 or 40 cameras with stickers showing their names and date. 2. You deliver the cameras with small table signs explaining how to use them. 3. After the wedding you collect the cameras, a partner film lab develops and scans the photos, and you send a private online album within 2–3 weeks. 4. Add-ons include a printed photo book and the same service for birthdays and office parties. Who pays and how much: Young couples, especially for mehendi, sangeet and haldi. About ₹2,500–3,000 a camera, including developing and scans. Proof it works abroad: Joy, USA: a wedding-planning website that sells packs of 3, 5 or 10 disposable cameras with professional developing, digital scans and free return postage included. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found offering it as a full service. WedMeGood suggests couples do it themselves. To start: About ₹90,000 (40 cameras, a lab tie-up, stickers, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: cameras and film are costly imports that can run short, and some indoor shots come out dark.

35

Detective mystery boxes by post

A box of letters, photos, maps and clues arrives; you and friends solve the case at home. What's missing in India today: Young couples and groups of friends want fun, screen-free things to do at home. Escape rooms cost a lot and are far away, and there is no Indian "solve the case at home" game set in Indian places. How it works: 1. A freelance writer creates a mystery set in India, such as a missing painting in an old Kolkata mansion. 2. A printer makes the clue letters, photos, maps and small props, and you pack them into boxes. 3. Customers buy one box, or a "season" of 3–6 boxes posted monthly, and check their final answer on WhatsApp. 4. You sell it as a gift for couples and birthdays, and to offices for team fun. Who pays and how much: Couples, friend groups and puzzle lovers. About ₹1,499–1,999 a box. Proof it works abroad: Hunt A Killer, USA: each mystery is a "season" of six monthly boxes of clues, at about \$25 a month. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. The only close product is a children's detective board game (Bloomingo's "Mumbai Files"). To start: About ₹1,20,000 (writer, freelance designer, printing 200 boxes, ads). About 6–8 weeks. Main risk: the first story must be truly gripping, and each new story costs money to write.

36

New Year lucky bags

Sealed mystery bags from good brands, sold around 1 January, always worth more than the price. What's missing in India today: Indian brands end the year with leftover stock and run dull sales. Shoppers love surprises and unboxing videos, but India has no New Year "lucky bag" tradition. How it works: 1. You sign up 15–30 small Indian brands (skincare, stationery, snacks, clothes, home decor) to sell you leftover stock and samples cheaply. 2. You fill sealed bags at three price levels, each holding goods worth about 2–3 times the price. 3. You take online pre-bookings in December and run a 1–3 day pop-up stall at a mall or café around 1 January. 4. Brands gain new customers, you keep the profit, and buyers' unboxing Reels advertise the next year's bags. Who pays and how much: Shoppers aged 18–35 and gift buyers. Bags at about ₹999, ₹1,999 and ₹4,999. Proof it works abroad: Disney Store Japan, Japan: one of many shops selling New Year lucky bags (fukubukuro); its ¥3,500 bag holds goods worth about ¥10,500. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. To start: About ₹1,50,000 (stock bought from brands, bags, pop-up stall rent, ads). About 8–10 weeks, with pre-bookings from December. Main risk: buyers feeling cheated if bags look like junk, so choose brands carefully.

37

Stick-on body warmers for North Indian winters

Thin stick-on pads that stay warm for hours inside your clothes, for cold North Indian winters. What's missing in India today: North Indian winters are cold, and many homes, offices, buses and wedding lawns have no heating. In Japan people stick small warming pads inside their clothes, but in India they are hard to find and sold only without a brand. How it works: 1. You buy ready-made warming pads (they heat up when the pack is opened and air reaches them) from a factory that already makes them. 2. You pack them under your brand for the body, hands and feet. 3. You sell online, through chemists, to bike-taxi and delivery fleets, to planners of outdoor night weddings, and to trekking companies. 4. Your Reels show winter hacks for Delhi mornings, night weddings and Himalayan trips. Who pays and how much: Office-goers, two-wheeler riders, outdoor wedding guests and trekkers. About ₹299 for 10 pads. Proof it works abroad: Kobayashi Pharmaceutical, Japan: sells Kiribai Kairo warming pads for hands, body and feet, some lasting up to 24 hours. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: Only unbranded sellers were found on IndiaMART, for example Warmzy hand warmers at ₹350 for two pairs. To start: About ₹1,20,000 (first stock, packaging, ads, reserve). About 5–7 weeks, and the cold peaks in December–January. Main risk: a short season, import delays, and skin burns if instructions are not clear.

38

Laundry detergent sheets for hostels, PGs and travel

Thin sheets of detergent: tear one off, drop it in the wash. No spills, no heavy packs. What's missing in India today: Students in hostels and paying-guest rooms, people living alone, and travellers carry heavy, leaky detergent packs. Light, mess-free detergent sheets are popular abroad, but in India only a couple of brands sell them, one mainly for baby clothes. How it works: 1. A factory that already makes detergent sheets packs them under your brand (a travel pack of 10 and a monthly pack of 30). 2. You sell online and through hostel shops, college fests, paying-guest owners and travel stores. 3. You offer a "hostel laundry kit" with sheets, a mesh laundry bag and a stain pen. 4. Your Reels compare a neat pack of sheets with a backpack soaked in spilt liquid. Who pays and how much: Students, young people living alone and frequent travellers. About ₹199 for 30 sheets. Proof it works abroad: Earth Breeze, USA: calls itself the top laundry-sheet brand and says over 3 million people use it. ([source](#)) Who does this in India now: SuperBottoms (sheets for baby clothes and cloth nappies) and Lavella (a seed-funded detergent-sheet startup). To start: About ₹1,20,000 (samples, first 3,000 packs, packaging, ads). About 6–8 weeks. Main risk: cheap washing powder is hard to beat on price, so the selling point must be convenience.

Professionals, students and small businesses

39

Someone who quits your job for you

A service that resigns from your job for you and handles the awkward calls and final paperwork.

What's missing in India today: Many young employees dread telling a pushy boss they are leaving, and then spend weeks chasing their last salary, relieving letter (the letter that proves you left properly) and PF (provident fund) transfer. We found no Indian service that does this for you.

How it works:

1. The customer fills a short form: company, last working day they want, and what they are still owed.
2. You send a polite, firm resignation email on their behalf and track every step on a simple checklist.
3. A partner HR professional (a freelancer who has handled many exits) talks to the company's HR team, agrees the notice period and chases the last salary, relieving letter and PF transfer.
4. If there is a legal fight, you pass the customer to a partner lawyer, who charges separately.

Who pays and how much: Salaried people aged about 22–35 leaving a stressful job. About ₹2,999 for the resignation and handover talks, or about ₹5,999 including chasing the last salary, relieving letter and PF.

Proof it works abroad: Momuri, Japan: charges ¥22,000 for full-time workers and says it has helped 20,000 people quit their jobs. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹40,000 (simple website, form, email templates checked by a lawyer, first Reels ads). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: some companies will refuse to talk to an outsider, and the customer still has to serve the notice period.

40

Job-offer negotiation help, paid only if your offer goes up

Experts coach you through negotiating a job offer and take a small cut only if your pay rises.

What's missing in India today: Many people accept the first number a company offers, even when recruiters expect some bargaining. Free tips exist online, but no one sits with you, writes your replies and gets paid only when it works.

How it works:

1. The customer shares the offer letter and any other offers they have.
2. You find out the usual pay range for that role with your partner and send the customer a simple plan.
3. A partner (an experienced recruiter or HR manager working freelance) writes the emails and call scripts and coaches the customer before each call.
4. If the final offer is higher, the customer pays a share of the increase.

Who pays and how much: Mid-level people in tech, finance and sales who are switching jobs. About 8% of the first year's increase (for example, about ₹16,000 on a ₹2 lakh raise), and nothing if the offer does not go up.

Proof it works abroad: Rora, USA: charges a percentage of the extra pay it negotiates ("No increase, no fee") and says it has helped more than 1,200 people since 2017. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search; only free articles and tips.

To start: About ₹50,000 (website, simple contract, LinkedIn and Reels ads). About 3–5 weeks. Main risk: customers may hide the final number, so ask for the signed offer letter before you start.

41 Someone who bargains your new car price for you

An expert gets quotes from several dealers and cuts hidden charges before you buy a new car.

What's missing in India today: First-time car buyers face "handling charges", forced accessories and costly dealer insurance, and they don't know what discount is possible. Few people have the time or nerve to bargain with five dealers.

How it works:

1. The customer tells you the car model, version and city.
2. A partner (a former car salesman working freelance) asks several dealers for written quotes by phone and WhatsApp.
3. The partner pushes for the best price, removes unfair add-ons and checks the car before delivery.
4. The customer pays a fixed fee, and you refund it if you can't beat their own best quote.

Who pays and how much: Young professionals buying their first or second car. About ₹4,999 per car, or about ₹7,999 with a check of the car before delivery.

Proof it works abroad: Delivrd, USA: charges \$1,000 per deal, has five negotiators and brings in about \$200,000 a month. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: RowthAutos (a website that bargained with car dealers for buyers in north India; whether it still runs was not checked).

To start: About ₹40,000 (partner fees for the first cases, Reels, ads). About 2–3 weeks; year-end discounts in December help. Main risk: some dealers refuse to deal with a middleman, so the customer may need to do the final visit.

42 Daytime workspace in empty bars and restaurants

Bars and restaurants that are empty until evening become paid daytime workspaces for remote workers.

What's missing in India today: Many bars and dinner restaurants sit empty until 6 pm, while remote workers crowd cafés and feel bad holding a table all day. Only a few Indian players do this, and mostly with lounges and cafés.

How it works:

1. You sign up 4–6 bars and restaurants in one area that are empty from 10 am to 5 pm.
2. Members buy a day pass or monthly pass and book a seat on WhatsApp.
3. The venue gives Wi-Fi, charging points and unlimited tea or coffee, and earns extra from food orders.
4. You share the pass money with the venue and run a small weekly event to build a community.

Who pays and how much: Remote and hybrid workers, freelancers and students preparing for exams. About ₹249 a day or about ₹2,999 a month.

Proof it works abroad: KettleSpace, USA: turned underused restaurants and hotels in New York into daytime workspaces for just under \$100 a month, with 6 spaces at the time. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: myHQ (has turned 60+ lounges and cafés into workspaces) and SOHO Space (Mumbai; whether it still runs was not checked). Friyey tried workspaces in bars but shut down in 2023.

To start: About ₹40,000 (venue tie-ups, signs, Wi-Fi boosters, Reels). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: myHQ could move into your area, so lock in the best venues first.

43

Small monthly support groups for new managers

About eight new managers from different companies meet monthly with a guide to solve real team problems.

What's missing in India today: People promoted to manager often get little training, and they can't talk openly with colleagues about a difficult team member or boss. There is no simple, private group where new managers can learn from each other.

How it works:

1. People apply, and you group about 8 managers at a similar level from different companies (never two from the same company).
2. A partner guide (an experienced HR leader or coach) runs a 2-hour session each month, in person or online.
3. In each session, members bring a real problem and the group helps solve it; a WhatsApp group keeps going between sessions.
4. You sell seats to individuals, and to companies as a learning benefit for their staff.

Who pays and how much: First-time managers with about 3–8 years of work experience, or their companies. About ₹2,500 a month per person, or about ₹25,000 a year.

Proof it works abroad: Chief, USA: a paid network of more than 10,000 senior women leaders who meet in small "Core Groups". ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No paid peer group found. Only formal courses exist, such as IIM Indore's programme for first-time managers ([IIM Indore](#)).

To start: About ₹30,000 (guide fees for the first groups, venue, LinkedIn and Reels ads). About 4 weeks. Main risk: members drop out after 2–3 months, so sell 6-month seats.

44

Bicycle on a monthly plan, repairs included

Pay a monthly fee for your own bicycle; if it breaks, a mechanic fixes or swaps it free.

What's missing in India today: Many office-goers and students live a short ride from the metro, office or college, but buying a good cycle and paying for repairs puts them off. There is no simple "your own cycle, fixed for free" monthly plan.

How it works:

1. The customer picks a cycle and a monthly plan, and pays a deposit.
2. A partner cycle shop supplies the cycles (or you buy a small first batch) and delivers them with a lock.
3. The partner shop's mechanic fixes any problem within 48 hours, or swaps the cycle.
4. You sell to people living near metro stations, tech parks and colleges.

Who pays and how much: Office-goers, students and metro commuters. About ₹699–999 a month, plus a refundable deposit of about ₹2,000.

Proof it works abroad: Swapfiets, Netherlands: its monthly fee includes the bicycle, maintenance and repairs, and it had more than 220,000 bicycles in 64 cities in 2021. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: 1: Gro Club in Bengaluru rents bicycles to kids and adults with doorstep delivery and repairs ([Dealroom](#)).

To start: About ₹1,50,000 if you buy 20 cycles yourself, or about ₹40,000 if a partner shop owns them. About 4 weeks. Main risk: theft and damage, so take deposits and hand out strong locks.

45

Interview suits on rent for placement season

Rent a fitted formal suit, shirt and tie for campus placements or job interviews, then return it.

What's missing in India today: Final-year students need a suit for a few interview days and may never wear it again, yet buying one costs thousands. We found no one in India who rents plain interview suits to students.

How it works:

1. Students book a size and a pick-up slot on WhatsApp or through their college placement team.
2. You keep a stock of plain navy, grey and black suits, shirts and ties at a partner tailor's shop near the colleges.
3. The partner tailor does quick fittings and small changes, and a partner dry cleaner cleans each set after it comes back.
4. Students keep the suit for 3–4 days and return it; you hold a refundable deposit until then.

Who pays and how much: Final-year engineering and MBA students and freshers going to interviews. About ₹799 for 3 days (suit, shirt and tie), plus a refundable deposit of about ₹2,000.

Proof it works abroad: Yofuku no Aoyama, Japan: this suit retailer rents plain "recruit suits" to job-hunting students at a lower cost than buying one. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹1,50,000 (about 60 suit sets from wholesale markets, cleaning, a few college tie-ups). About 3–4 weeks, in time for winter placement drives. Main risk: suits sit unused outside placement season.

46

Ready room boxes for hostel and PG move-in

Parents order one box with bedding, bucket, lamp and other basics, delivered to the hostel or PG room.

What's missing in India today: Every year, families make long lists and run around markets to buy the same bedsheets, pillow, bucket, extension board and hangers. Colleges publish these lists, but no one sells everything as one ready box delivered to the room.

How it works:

1. Parents pick a box (basic, comfort or premium) and give the hostel or PG address.
2. You buy in bulk from wholesale suppliers, and a partner packer packs the boxes.
3. A delivery partner drops the box at the hostel gate or PG on move-in day.
4. You tie up with student groups and PG owners, who get a small cut for each box sold.

Who pays and how much: Parents of first-year students, and young people joining a PG for a new job. About ₹3,499–6,999 per box.

Proof it works abroad: OCM (On Campus Marketing), USA: sells bedding, bath sets and care packages for students and serves over 900 campuses in North America. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found for Indian hostels. AmberStudent and Discounto sell similar kits, but only for students going abroad.

To start: About ₹1,20,000 (stock for about 40 boxes, packing, college tie-ups). About 4–6 weeks; January semester starts and new PG joiners come first, and July–August is the big season. Main risk: unsold stock outside admission season.

47

Student discount card for shops near campus

Students buy a yearly card that gets them discounts at cafés, salons and shops near their college.

What's missing in India today: Student discounts in India are mostly for big online brands. Small cafés, photocopy shops, gyms and salons near a college want students on slow weekdays, but have no simple way to reach them.

How it works:

1. You sign up 20–30 shops around one college area, and each agrees to a 10–20% student discount.
2. Students buy the card (on WhatsApp or as a plastic card) and show it with their college ID.
3. Shops pay you a small monthly fee to be listed and shown in your Reels.
4. You repeat this around the next group of colleges.

Who pays and how much: Students pay about ₹199 a year; shops pay about ₹1,000 a month.

Proof it works abroad: TOTUM, UK: sells a student discount card for £14.99 a year. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: RCMH Card, UNiDAYS and Student Beans offer student discounts, but mostly on national and online brands; no local campus card found.

To start: About ₹40,000 (cards, a freelance designer, Reels). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: shops stop giving the discount, so check in with each shop every month.

48

Flatmate speed-meeting nights

An evening at a bar or café where people with a spare room meet people who need one.

What's missing in India today: Young people find flatmates through crowded Facebook groups and apps, then meet strangers one by one. There is no friendly event where you can meet 30 possible flatmates in one evening.

How it works:

1. People sign up and say whether they have a room or need one, with their budget and area.
2. You host a weekly evening at a partner café or bar, with coloured name badges ("room to share" or "need a room").
3. The partner venue earns from food and drinks; you keep the ticket money.
4. After the event, you send a WhatsApp list of who came, so people can follow up.

Who pays and how much: Working people and students aged about 21–32 in cities like Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, Gurugram or Mumbai. About ₹299 a ticket with one drink, and about ₹499 for people with a room to fill.

Proof it works abroad: SpareRoom, UK: by 2018 it had run SpeedFlatmating nights for almost ten years, every week in London and Manchester (free to attend, to bring people to its flat-share website). ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found. Housr matches roommates only inside its own rental homes, and Flatchat (a flatmate app) has shut down.

To start: About ₹30,000 (badges, first venue deal, Reels ads). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: too few people with rooms turn up, so recruit room-owners first.

49

Dating-app photo shoots

A relaxed photo shoot in cafés and streets that gives you natural, good photos for dating apps.

What's missing in India today: Most people use blurry selfies or group photos on Hinge, Bumble and Tinder. We found no Indian studio offering a natural, "not too posed" dating-photo package.

How it works:

1. The customer books a 60-minute slot and picks 2–3 outfits.
2. You plan the spots (café, street, park) and tell the customer what kind of photos work on apps.
3. A partner photographer shoots and edits 15–20 natural-looking photos.
4. If they want, a partner writer helps rewrite their profile text.

Who pays and how much: Single working professionals aged about 24–38. About ₹3,999 for 15 edited photos, or about ₹6,999 with profile help.

Proof it works abroad: Shannon Kathleen Photography, USA: dating photo packages start at \$749, and the owner says dating shoots are now the biggest part of her business. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search; AI photo apps are the nearest substitute.

To start: About ₹30,000 (sample shoots, Reels, ads). About 2 weeks. Main risk: people feel shy about buying it, so also sell it as "profile photos" for LinkedIn and Instagram.

50

Someone checks your rental flat abroad before you pay

Before a student pays a deposit abroad, a local person visits the flat and sends a video report.

What's missing in India today: Indian students going to the UK, Canada, Australia or Germany often pay deposits for flats they have never seen, and rental scams are common. Booking sites list checked student halls, but no one visits a private flat you found yourself.

How it works:

1. The student sends the listing link and address.
2. You assign a partner: an Indian student or graduate already living in that city, paid per visit.
3. The partner visits, does a live video call, checks that the landlord's ID matches, and fills a checklist (damp, heating, safety, transport).
4. You send the family a short report within 48 hours.

Who pays and how much: Students going abroad and their parents. About ₹3,999 per flat, or about ₹9,999 for three flats.

Proof it works abroad: Propzee, Australia: inspects rental homes for people who can't view them, such as students and people moving from overseas, for A\$179 with a report within 8 hours. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found doing in-person checks. Amber, InstaDwell and Student.com list checked student housing, but they don't visit a private flat you found yourself.

To start: About ₹50,000 (partners in 5–6 cities found through alumni groups, website, Reels). About 3–4 weeks; the January intake is close. Main risk: finding reliable checkers in every city.

51

Part-time job starter pack for students going to Australia

Before flying, students get the certificates, CV and practice they need to find café and bar jobs quickly.

What's missing in India today: Many Indian students in Australia need part-time work in their first weeks, but cafés and bars ask for certificates such as the RSA (Responsible Service of Alcohol) and barista skills. Most students only find this out after landing and lose weeks.

How it works:

1. The student signs up 4–8 weeks before flying.
2. You help them book the right state-approved courses (such as the RSA and food safety) with Australian training providers.
3. A partner barista trainer in India runs a 1-day hands-on coffee class, and a partner who has worked in Australia rewrites the CV and runs a mock café interview.
4. You give each student a list of suburbs and job boards for their city.

Who pays and how much: Students going to Australia and their parents. About ₹9,999 for the pack, plus course fees paid directly to the training provider.

Proof it works abroad: CBD College, Australia: sells an RSA plus barista course package for A\$359, welcomes student-visa holders and sells it for "maximum hospitality employability". ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹50,000 (barista class tie-up, tie-ups with study-abroad consultants, Reels). About 3–4 weeks; students flying for the February–March start are the first batch. Main risk: the pack is only as good as the jobs students find, and student-visa work rules can change.

52

Office-culture coaching before you start a job abroad

Short coaching that teaches people moving abroad how emails, meetings and small talk work in their new office.

What's missing in India today: Indians moving to Germany, Japan, the UK or the US for work often struggle with unwritten office rules, like how direct to be or how to disagree in a meeting. Big companies buy this training for their staff, but individuals and small hiring agencies have no simple option.

How it works:

1. The customer picks a country and books a pack of 3 sessions (online or in person).
2. You match them with a partner coach: an Indian who has worked in that country for 5+ years.
3. Sessions cover emails, meetings, feedback, small talk and the first 90 days, with role-play.
4. You also sell group batches to agencies that send nurses, engineers and drivers abroad.

Who pays and how much: People who just got a job abroad, and agencies that place workers overseas. About ₹6,999 per person, or about ₹40,000 for a batch of 15.

Proof it works abroad: Commisceo Global, UK: has run cross-cultural training for more than 20 years and says it has delivered over 1,000 training programmes. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: Global Adjustments, which mainly trains company employees.

To start: About ₹35,000 (coach tie-ups, sample session videos, outreach to agencies). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: people think free YouTube videos are enough, so sell through agencies too.

53

Therapy rooms you can book by the hour

Quiet, cosy rooms that counsellors, dietitians and coaches can book by the hour to meet clients.

What's missing in India today: Many counsellors and coaches work alone and can't afford their own clinic, so they meet clients online or in noisy cafés. Coworking spaces rent plain meeting rooms, but not calm, private rooms set up for therapy.

How it works:

1. A therapist books a room slot on WhatsApp or a simple booking page.
2. You rent the spare rooms of a partner clinic, coworking space or wellness studio at a fixed weekly rate, or share the money per hour.
3. The partner keeps the rooms clean and runs the front desk; you add soft lighting, a sofa set-up and a "session in progress" sign.
4. You fill the slots by selling to counsellors, dietitians, life coaches and tutors.

Who pays and how much: Freelance counsellors, psychologists, dietitians and coaches. About ₹400–600 an hour, or about ₹6,000 for a monthly pack of 15 hours.

Proof it works abroad: Good Therapy, Australia: lists 70+ consulting rooms that therapists can hire, with one Melbourne room at A\$35 an hour. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹80,000 (furnishing two rooms, deposit, first ads in therapist WhatsApp and LinkedIn groups). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: rooms sit empty on weekday mornings.

54

Festival paintings on shop windows

Artists paint bright festival scenes on the glass fronts of cafés and shops, then wash them off later.

What's missing in India today: Big stores hire design studios for festival window displays, but small cafés, salons and clinics just hang a few lights. There is no simple, low-cost window-painting service for Christmas, New Year, Holi or big match days.

How it works:

1. You sell festival windows to shop owners, often 10 shops on one street at a time.
2. Each shop picks a design from your catalogue.
3. A partner artist (an art student or mural painter) paints the glass with washable paint in 1–2 hours.
4. After the festival, a partner cleaner removes it, or you sell the next festival's design.

Who pays and how much: Cafés, salons, clinics, sweet shops and boutiques. About ₹2,500–6,000 per window, depending on size.

Proof it works abroad: The "Novemberistas", USA: an artist and the painters she recruits paint holiday scenes on the windows of more than 100 Ann Arbor businesses each winter. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found for small shops. Big stores use display studios such as Pencilbox Design and Surreal Design Studio.

To start: About ₹30,000 (paints, sample windows, catalogue, Reels). About 2–3 weeks; Christmas and New Year are the first chance. Main risk: it is seasonal, so line up many festivals and events across the year.

55

Regular shop-window cleaning for shops and clinics

A crew cleans the glass fronts and signboards of shops and clinics on a fixed weekly schedule.

What's missing in India today: Dusty glass and grimy signboards make a shop look closed or cheap, especially after dust storms and monsoon rain. Shop staff wipe them now and then, but rarely well or regularly.

How it works:

1. You sell weekly or fortnightly plans street by street, so one crew can clean 15–20 shops in a morning.
2. A partner cleaning crew (two people with ladders, squeegees and long water poles) cleans before the shops open.
3. You send each owner a before-and-after photo on WhatsApp after every visit.
4. You add extras: signboard washing, awning cleaning and a festival-season deep clean.

Who pays and how much: Shops, clinics, cafés, showrooms and salons. About ₹1,200–2,500 a month per shop for weekly cleaning.

Proof it works abroad: Fish Window Cleaning, USA: has more than 270 locally owned locations in 44 states and has served over 200,000 business and home customers since 1978. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No dedicated shop-window service found; general cleaning companies do one-off jobs.

To start: About ₹40,000 (tools for one crew, uniforms, a guaranteed first month of pay for the crew). About 2 weeks. Main risk: low price per shop, so you need many shops close together.

56

Salon chairs for freelance beauticians, by the day

Freelance hairstylists and makeup artists rent an empty chair or small room in a salon by the day.

What's missing in India today: Many beauticians work freelance and visit clients' homes, but some clients want a proper salon setting and the artist can't afford a shop. Meanwhile, many salons have empty chairs on weekdays.

How it works:

1. You sign up salons that have spare chairs or a spare room on weekdays.
2. Freelance hairstylists, nail artists and makeup artists book a chair by the half-day or day through you.
3. The salon gives the chair, power and washbasin; the freelancer brings their own products and clients.
4. You keep a booking fee and promote the freelancers on your Instagram.

Who pays and how much: Freelance beauty workers pay about ₹800–1,500 a day; the salon gets most of it and you keep about 20%.

Proof it works abroad: Sola Salon Studios, USA: rents ready-to-use salon suites to independent beauty workers and says 21,000+ of them use it. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian chair-rental service found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹25,000 (salon tie-ups, simple rules and agreement, Reels). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: salons fear freelancers will take their customers, so agree clear rules first.

57

Handwritten thank-you cards for small businesses

Real people handwrite thank-you, birthday and New Year cards to a business's customers and post them.

What's missing in India today: Small businesses send the same forwarded WhatsApp greetings as everyone else, so nobody notices. A real handwritten card stands out, but owners have no time to write hundreds.

How it works:

1. The business shares its customer list and picks a card design and message.
2. You print the cards with a partner printer.
3. Partner writers (students with neat handwriting, paid per card) write each card by hand, with the customer's name and a personal line.
4. You post them by India Post or courier, timed for birthdays, festivals or right after a purchase.

Who pays and how much: Property agents, insurance and investment advisers, clinics, jewellers and small online brands. About ₹60–90 per card including postage, or about ₹15,000 for a batch of 200.

Proof it works abroad: Handwrytten, USA: sends handwritten cards for businesses using robots that hold real pens; one customer says it sends over 15,000 cards a month. ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian service found. US examples are Simply Noted and Handwrytten (Simply Noted).

To start: About ₹25,000 (sample cards, printing, the first 10 writers). About 2 weeks; Christmas and New Year cards are the first chance. Main risk: every card must be checked for spelling and neat writing.

58

Ready-to-rent furniture packs for landlords

Landlords buy one fixed-price package that fully furnishes an empty flat in about a week.

What's missing in India today: Many flat owners in IT hubs want to rent to young professionals who prefer furnished homes, but furnishing means weeks of shopping and chasing workers. No one sells simple, fixed-price "furnish my rental flat" packs to landlords.

How it works:

1. The landlord picks a pack (1BHK, 2BHK or 3BHK) and a budget level.
2. You measure the flat with a partner and order from partner furniture and appliance suppliers at trade prices.
3. Partners deliver and set up everything in about a week, and you take photos for the rental listing.
4. You earn a share of the pack price, plus an optional fee for finding the first tenant through a partner broker.

Who pays and how much: Owners of flats in cities like Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Gurugram who rent to professionals. About ₹1,50,000–3,00,000 per flat, of which you keep about 12–15%.

Proof it works abroad: InStyle Direct through Benham & Reeves, UK: sells landlord furniture packs from £3,395 + VAT to help landlords "maximise their asking rents". ([source](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found selling packs to landlords. Flent furnishes and runs rental homes itself, and FlatFurnish rents furniture to tenants.

To start: About ₹50,000 (sample catalogue, supplier deals, broker tie-ups). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: supplier delays or damage land on you, so take full payment upfront and pass on supplier warranties.

Families, NRIs, elderly parents and life moments

59

A printed family newspaper for grandparents, every month

The family sends photos and news on WhatsApp; grandparents get them as a printed newspaper every month. What's missing in India today: Many grandparents find busy WhatsApp groups and small phone screens hard to follow, so they miss most family photos and news. A quick search found no one in India who turns a family's updates into a printed paper they can hold, reread and show friends. How it works:

1. A son, daughter or grandchild (often abroad) signs up, and you add the whole family to a WhatsApp group that you run.
2. Through the month, everyone sends photos with a line or two of news.
3. Your freelance designer puts them into a ready-made layout: 8–12 pages, big letters, in English or the grandparents' own language.
4. A local printer prints it and a courier delivers it to the grandparents' door in the first week of every month.

Who pays and how much: NRI and out-of-town children. About ₹999 a month, or about ₹9,999 a year paid in advance. Design, printing and courier cost you about ₹350–450 a copy. **Proof it works abroad:** Famileo, France: over 260,000 families have subscribed to its printed family "gazette" for grandparents, which starts at \$9.99 a month. (source) **Who does this in India now:** No one found in a quick search. Only foreign services (Famileo, Lineage, Familink) came up. **To start:** About ₹60,000 (layout design, sample issues, ads aimed at Indians in the US, UK, Canada and the Gulf). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying family. Main risk: families stop sending photos after two months, so you must keep nudging them.

60

Picture books read aloud in a grandparent's own voice

Grandparents in India record themselves reading a picture book; grandchildren abroad hear them every time they open it. What's missing in India today: NRI children mostly hear their grandparents on rushed video calls across time zones. Books that play a grandparent's recorded voice on each page are a common gift in the US, but a quick search found none sold in India, and none in Hindi, Tamil, Bengali or other Indian languages. How it works:

1. The NRI parent chooses a book (a classic picture book or a short Indian folk tale) and orders online.
2. Your partner, a trained student helper, visits the grandparents with the book. The grandparents read each page aloud in their own language and add a short message.
3. A printer adds a QR code on each page that plays that page's recording on any phone. A costlier version has a small built-in speaker in the book.
4. You ship the finished book abroad, or hand it over when the family visits in December.

Who pays and how much: NRI parents and grandparents. About ₹2,999 for the QR-code book and about ₹4,999 for the built-in-speaker book, plus overseas shipping. **Proof it works abroad:** Hallmark, US: sells 29 recordable storybook titles, most at \$39.99, so family members far away can "read" to children. (source) **Who does this in India now:** No one found in a quick search. Hallmark sells these books in the US, Canada and Australia. **To start:** About ₹80,000 (first 30 books, printing, home-visit helpers, ads). About 4 weeks to the first order. Main risk: imported sound parts can be unreliable, so start with the QR-code version, which needs no electronics.

61

Flight companions for parents flying alone to visit their children abroad

A checked, friendly helper flies with elderly parents from the Indian airport to their child waiting at arrivals. **What's missing in India today:** Every year many Indian parents fly alone to the US, UK, Canada or Australia to visit children, often for months. Many fear transit airports, forms and long walks, and their children lose sleep. Airlines give a wheelchair, but no one sits with them through the whole journey. **How it works:**

1. The child abroad books online and shares the parents' flight details.
2. You match a companion who is already flying that route (for example, students and young professionals going back after holidays). Every companion has police verification, a short training and a written agreement.
3. The companion meets the parents at check-in, sits near them, helps through transit and immigration, and sends WhatsApp updates to the child.
4. The companion hands the parents over to the child at arrivals.

Who pays and how much: NRI children. About ₹15,000–25,000 per one-way trip; you pay the companion about ₹8,000–12,000. **Proof it works abroad:** Juurnee, Australia: more than 12,000 people signed up in its first year to match travellers with paid flight companions; listings include helping solo parents on flights to India, and one helper earned £270 for a 25-hour trip. (source) **Who does this in India now:** No paid one-to-one flight companion service found in a quick search. Close but different: SeniorWorld (Haryana) runs escorted group holidays for people over 55, and Goodfellows offers companionship to seniors in their own city. **To start:** About ₹70,000 (verification, training, a simple booking form, ads in NRI Facebook groups). About 3–4 weeks to the first booking; December–January is the busiest season. Main risk: a health problem mid-flight. Companions must never give medical help, and every traveller must have travel insurance.

62

Portrait day for grandparents, with hair and make-up

Grandparents get dressed up, have hair and make-up done, and receive a beautiful framed portrait. **What's missing in India today:** Most families have no good recent photo of their parents, only blurry phone pictures. When one is needed, for a 75th birthday, an anniversary or sadly a prayer meeting, they scramble. A quick search found no Indian studio that specialises in making older people look and feel their best. **How it works:**

1. Children (often abroad) book a slot for their parents, or the parents book for themselves.
2. A car brings them to a partner studio, where a make-up artist spends about 45 unhurried minutes on hair and make-up.
3. A partner photographer takes solo and couple portraits, and the parents pick their favourites on a screen.
4. You deliver a large framed print and the digital photos, and send the files to the children abroad.

Who pays and how much: Adult children (local and NRI) and older people themselves. About ₹6,999 for one person and about ₹9,999 for a couple, framed print included. **Proof it works abroad:** Egao Shashinkan, Japan: a Tokyo studio only for people over 60 photographs 100–120 people a month and has served more than 5,000 clients, starting each session with 40–60 minutes of hair and make-up. (source) **Who does this in India now:** No dedicated studio for older people found in a quick search. General portrait studios (such as MemoryCraft Studio in Pune) do one-off shoots. **To start:** About ₹50,000 (hiring a studio for test days, a sample shoot with 5 older models, frames, ads). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: the idea can feel sad, so sell it as a celebration ("Look your best at 70"), never as a funeral photo.

63

"What next" retreats for people who have just retired

A 3-day stay at a resort where newly retired people plan the next 20 years of their life. What's missing in India today: People who retire at 58–60 often feel lost: no office, no title, and children far away. **A quick search found no place in India where they can pause with others in the same situation and plan purpose, health, money and relationships for the next stage of life. How it works:**

1. Retirees, or their children as a gift, book a seat in a 3-day retreat for 20 people at a partner resort near the city.
2. You build the programme with partners: a life coach, a money planner (talks only), a fitness trainer, and older guests who built a happy "second innings".
3. Everyone leaves with a written personal plan and a WhatsApp group of new friends.
4. You run a paid monthly online meet-up afterwards.

Who pays and how much: Retiring professionals, government officers and their children. About ₹35,000–45,000 per person including the stay; the resort costs about ₹12,000–15,000 per person. Big employers can also buy seats for staff who are about to retire. **Proof it works abroad:** Modern Elder Academy, Mexico: charges \$5,500 for a week-long course and has 3,000 alumni with an average age of 54.

(source) Who does this in India now: No residential retreat like this found in a quick search; only one-day talks, such as a Brahma Kumaris session for officers about to retire. **To start:** About ₹1,00,000 (resort advance, partner fees, ads). About 6–8 weeks to the first retreat. Main risk: filling the first 20 seats, so sell seats in advance to the staff (HR) teams at banks, government companies and large firms.

64

Rooms in older people's homes for students, in return for help and company

You match older people who have a spare room with a checked student who pays low rent and helps. What's missing in India today: Many older couples and widows live alone in big flats after their children move away, while students and young job-starters pay high rents. **A quick search found no service in India that matches them safely, with checks and clear rules, so neither side dares to try it. How it works:**

1. Older homeowners (or their children abroad) sign up, and you visit to see the room and agree house rules.
2. Students and young professionals apply. You do police verification, college or office checks and an interview.
3. You introduce a match, run a trial week, and use a simple written agreement: low rent plus about 10 hours a week of help, such as shopping, phone help and evening company.
4. You check in every month and sort out problems; either side can end it with notice.

Who pays and how much: The young person pays you about ₹3,000–5,000 a month, plus a low rent to the homeowner. Children abroad pay a one-time setup fee of about ₹10,000. **Proof it works abroad:** THE Homeshare, Ireland: the young person pays the company €195 a month in Dublin and gives the older homeowner 10 hours a week of their time. **(source) Who does this in India now:** No home-sharing match service found in a quick search. Companion firms such as Samvedna Senior Care send visitors for a few hours, which is different. **To start:** About ₹50,000 (verification costs, an agreement drafted by a lawyer, ads). About 6–8 weeks to the first match. Main risk: safety and trust; one bad incident can end the business, so checks must be strict.

65

Robot cats and dogs for lonely elderly parents

Selling soft, lifelike robot pets that purr and respond to touch, as gifts for parents living alone. What's missing in India today: Many older people living alone would love a pet but cannot walk a dog, clean up after it, or bear its death. Robot pets made for older people are popular in the US, but a quick search found no one selling them in India. How it works:

1. You import a small batch of robot pets made for older adults: cats and dogs that purr, bark and move when stroked.
2. NRI children order on your website or WhatsApp, and you gift-wrap each pet with a printed card.
3. A delivery helper hands it over and shows the parents how to switch it on and change batteries.
4. You also sell to old-age homes and day centres for older people.

Who pays and how much: NRI and local children. About ₹14,999–17,999 per pet; each pet costs you about ₹10,000–12,000 including import duty and shipping. **Proof it works abroad:** Ageless Innovation (Joy for All), US: had delivered 500,000 companion robot pets to older adults by November 2022. **(source)** **Who does this in India now:** No Indian seller found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹1,20,000 (first 8–10 pets, import duty, shipping, demo pieces for Reels). About 6–8 weeks. Main risk: customs may treat them as toys that need India's safety certificate (BIS), so ask a customs agent before you order.

66

Speech writers for weddings and family milestones

A writer helps you prepare a funny, moving speech for a sangeet, wedding, anniversary or retirement party. What's missing in India today: Speeches by siblings, parents and friends are now a big part of sangeets, receptions and 50th anniversaries, and people panic about them. Most copy lines from the internet. A quick search found no Indian brand that writes these speeches and coaches people to deliver them. How it works:

1. The customer fills a short form and has a 30-minute call with you about the couple or person: stories, jokes, family names.
2. Your partner writer (a copywriter or stand-up comic) drafts a 4–6 minute speech in English, Hindi or Hinglish within 3 days.
3. Two rounds of changes, plus an optional video session with a speaking coach to practise.
4. You also sell wedding vows for the couple and toasts for parents.

Who pays and how much: Brothers and sisters of the bride or groom, best friends, and children planning a parent's anniversary or retirement. About ₹3,999 for a speech and about ₹6,999 with coaching; the writer gets about ₹1,500–2,500. **Proof it works abroad:** Speechy, UK: a team of BBC-trained comedy writers who have written wedding speeches since 2015, with prices from £40. **(source)** **Who does this in India now:** No Indian speech-writing brand found in a quick search; only individual freelancers on sites like Fiverr. **To start:** About ₹40,000 (3–4 trained writers, sample speeches, Reels, ads). About 2 weeks; the wedding season runs to February. Main risk: it is easy to copy, so build the brand fast with funny "before and after" speech Reels.

67

Hosts for non-religious and mixed-culture wedding ceremonies

A trained host leads a personal vow ceremony for couples who want something beyond, or alongside, religious rituals. **What's missing in India today:** More couples now marry across religions, cultures or countries, or want a ceremony about their own story instead of rituals they don't understand. The legal part is a registration at an office, so the celebration itself has no one to lead it. Abroad, this host is called a "celebrant". **How it works:**

1. The couple books, and you match them with a host from your team (trained anchors, theatre artists or speakers).
2. The host meets the couple twice, learns their story, and writes a 20–30 minute script with vows, readings by family members, and chosen customs from both sides.
3. The host leads the ceremony at the venue, and you provide a printed vow booklet as a keepsake.
4. You sell the same service for vow renewals at 25th and 50th anniversaries.

Who pays and how much: Interfaith and intercultural couples, Indians marrying foreigners, and destination weddings. About ₹25,000–50,000 per ceremony; the host gets about ₹12,000–20,000. **Proof it works abroad:** Humanists UK: its celebrants lead more than 1,050 non-religious weddings a year in England and Wales, up 266% since 2004. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** One found: Ceremonies with Jack ("The Wedding Guy", Bengaluru), listed on WeddingWire India at ₹20,000 per event. **To start:** About ₹60,000 (training 3 hosts, a sample ceremony video, listings on wedding websites, ads). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: families may object to "no rituals", so offer a mix where a priest does the key rites and your host does the rest.

68

Teddy bears that play the baby's heartbeat

A soft toy with a tiny recorder inside that plays the unborn baby's heartbeat, or a grandparent's voice. **What's missing in India today:** Parents-to-be treasure the moment they first hear their baby's heartbeat, but they have no keepsake of it. In the US, clinics and scan studios sell "heartbeat bears"; a quick search found no one in India doing this. **How it works:**

1. The mother records the heartbeat on her phone during a routine check-up, with the doctor's permission, or the family records voices instead.
2. She sends you the sound file on WhatsApp and picks a soft toy.
3. Your partner loads the sound onto a small recorder, puts it inside the toy and gift-packs it with a card.
4. You deliver in 3–5 days, and also sell through baby shops and maternity photographers.

Who pays and how much: Expecting parents and grandparents; it suits godh bharai and baby showers. NRI grandparents can also record "I love you" for grandchildren abroad. About ₹1,999–2,999; the toy and recorder cost about ₹600–900. **Proof it works abroad:** Mid-City OBGYN, US: this women's clinic records the heartbeat during scans and puts it inside a choice of about 35 soft animals, at \$40 each. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No one found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹60,000 (first 50 toys and recorders, packaging, ads). About 3 weeks. Main risks: soft toys sold in India must meet BIS toy-safety rules, and doctors are cautious during scans because revealing a baby's sex is illegal in India, so sell only the sound and never anything about the sex.

69

Quilts and cushions made from a loved one's old clothes

Turning a late mother's sarees, a father's shirts or a baby's first clothes into a quilt, cushions or teddy. **What's missing in India today:** Families keep cupboards full of a departed parent's sarees and kurtas, or a child's outgrown clothes, because they cannot throw them away. A local tailor can stitch, but few trusted brands design a beautiful keepsake and handle precious clothes with care. **How it works:**

1. The customer picks a product (quilt, cushion set or memory teddy) and sends the clothes in a prepaid courier bag.
2. You send a design picture on WhatsApp for approval.
3. Your partner, a women's tailoring group or traditional quilt makers, cuts and stitches it and adds a label with the person's name and dates.
4. You return the finished keepsake along with any leftover fabric.

Who pays and how much: Grieving families, NRI children clearing a parent's home, and new parents. About ₹4,999 for two cushions, about ₹7,999 for a pair of memory teddies, and about ₹14,999–24,999 for a quilt. **Proof it works abroad:** Project Repat, US: has made more than 1 million quilts from customers' old T-shirts since 2012. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** One found: Sweet Root (Bengaluru, since 2013) makes memory quilts from old clothes. Many families also use local quilt makers informally. **To start:** About ₹50,000 (sample pieces, packaging, courier bags, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: damaging a precious saree, so get the customer's written OK before every cut and insure the courier.

70

The real newspaper from the day you were born

An original newspaper printed on someone's birth or wedding date, framed as a milestone gift. **What's missing in India today:** For 50th and 60th birthdays and anniversaries, children struggle to find a meaningful gift. In the UK, people buy the actual newspaper from the day the person was born. A quick search found no one in India selling old newspapers this way, even though they sit with collectors, libraries and old-paper dealers. **How it works:**

1. The customer gives the date and city (for example, The Times of India, Mumbai, 14 March 1966).
2. You find it through partners: old-paper dealers and collectors, or a paid reprint from the newspaper's own archive if no original exists.
3. A framer mounts it with a certificate and a short "what happened that day" card.
4. You deliver it ready to gift.

Who pays and how much: Children planning a parent's milestone birthday or anniversary. About ₹4,999 for a framed reprint and about ₹8,999–14,999 for a framed original. **Proof it works abroad:** Historic Newspapers, UK: owns more than 3 million original newspapers and has sold them as birthday gifts for over 30 years. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No Indian seller of original birthday newspapers found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹80,000 (a starter stock of old papers from dealers, frames, ads). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: you may not find the exact date, so always say upfront when you will send a reprint instead of an original.

71

Overnight "Happy Birthday" and "Welcome Baby" signs outside the home

Giant colourful letters appear outside someone's home overnight for their birthday or new baby, then disappear. **What's missing in India today:** Indian families love surprises, but decorators come only for big parties and need hours of setup. There is no quick, cheap way to make someone wake up to a giant "Happy 60th, Papa!" at their gate, society lawn or office desk. **How it works:**

1. The customer books online with the name, age, message, address and date.
2. Your two part-time helpers set up weatherproof letters and cut-outs late at night, with the society's permission.
3. The birthday person wakes up to the surprise, and the family takes photos.
4. Your helpers collect everything 24 hours later (72 hours for a new baby).

Who pays and how much: Families in gated societies and independent houses, offices, and NRI children surprising parents. About ₹2,499–3,999 per setup; it costs you about ₹600–900. **Proof it works abroad:** Card My Yard, US: started in 2014 by two Texas mothers; a custom sign set costs about \$70 and stays up 24 hours, or 72 hours for a baby announcement. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No one found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹1,00,000 (3–4 sign sets made by a sign-maker, transport, ads in society WhatsApp groups). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: society rules on what can be put up, so win over society managers first.

72

Short festival photo sessions for families

20-minute family photo slots at a ready-made festive set, at a fixed low price. **What's missing in India today:** Families want good festival photos, but a full photoshoot costs ₹15,000 or more and takes hours. In the US, photographers sell short "mini sessions" at a decorated set; a quick search found no one offering this format in India. **How it works:**

1. You rent a space (a café, clubhouse or garden) for a weekend, and a decorator builds a festive set: Christmas, Lohri, Pongal, Eid or Diwali.
2. Families book 20-minute slots online and pay in advance.
3. Your partner photographer shoots about 20 families a day and delivers 10–15 edited photos within a week.
4. You also sell prints, frames and calendars.

Who pays and how much: Young families, NRI families home in December, and grandparents with grandchildren. About ₹3,999–4,999 per slot. **Proof it works abroad:** Bloom (photography software company), US: says holiday mini sessions usually last 15–30 minutes, give 5–15 photos, sell for about \$119, and a full day can bring a photographer \$2,000 or more. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No festival mini-session offers found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹60,000 per weekend (set, venue, photographer, ads). About 3 weeks; the first weekend can be Christmas–New Year 2026, then Lohri and Pongal in January. Main risk: empty slots, so sell all slots before paying for the venue.

73

Gift wish-lists for weddings, baby showers and housewarmings

Couples and parents-to-be make one wish-list, so guests buy what is actually needed, not duplicates. What's missing in India today: Weddings and baby showers bring piles of repeat dinner sets, wall clocks and baby clothes, while the couple still has to buy what they really need. Guests also don't know what to give. Gift lists are normal in the US but rare in India.

How it works:

1. The couple or parents-to-be fill a form or meet you, and pick items (from a mixer to a pram to a weekend trip) from partner shops and websites.
2. A freelancer builds a simple web page on a ready-made website builder, with a QR code for the invitation card.
3. Guests pick an item, or chip in money towards a big one, and partner shops deliver after the event.
4. You charge the couple a setup fee and earn a commission from shops.

Who pays and how much: Urban couples, NRI couples marrying in India, and parents-to-be. About ₹4,999 setup fee, plus about 5–10% commission from partner shops. **Proof it works abroad:** Babylist, US: the baby gift-list company made over \$750 million in revenue in 2025, up 45%, and has been profitable eight years in a row. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** 3: Wedding Wishlist (Chennai) ([Inc42](#)), ForMyShaadi and Kiki ([YourStory](#)). At the limit; you would need a sharper angle, such as NRI guests. **To start:** About ₹70,000 (simple website, shop tie-ups, ads). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: Indian guests are used to giving cash (shagun), so include a "chip in cash" option.

74

Classes that prepare children to become a big brother or sister

A fun 90-minute Saturday class and gift kit that gets small children ready for a new baby.

What's missing in India today: When a new baby arrives, the older child often feels jealous, scared or left out. Pregnancy classes in India are only for the mother and father, and a quick search found no classes that prepare the older child. **How it works:**

1. Parents book a class of 8–12 children aged 3–10 at a preschool, play centre or maternity hospital.
2. Your partner, an early-childhood teacher, runs games: holding a baby doll safely, gentle touch, talking about feelings, and how to help.
3. Each child takes home an "I'm a Big Sister / Big Brother" kit: T-shirt, certificate, small book and doll.
4. You sell through gynaecologists, maternity hospitals and pregnancy Instagram pages.

Who pays and how much: Parents expecting a second child. About ₹1,999 per child with the kit; the kit costs about ₹500 and the teacher about ₹2,000 a class. **Proof it works abroad:** Slidell Memorial Hospital, US: runs Big Brother / Big Sister classes for children about to become siblings, with 2026 dates listed, as many US hospitals do. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No one found in a quick search. **To start:** About ₹50,000 (first 60 kits, teacher training, venue tie-ups, ads). About 3–4 weeks. Main risk: a small market in one city, so partner with maternity hospital chains to include it in their pregnancy packages.

75

First-week kit and packed suitcase for children leaving to study abroad

Bedding, kitchen basics and Indian spices waiting for a child's first week abroad, all organised by you. **What's missing in India today:** About 12.5 lakh Indian students study abroad. Their parents pack huge suitcases with pressure cookers and bedsheets, pay for extra baggage, and the child still arrives at an empty room late at night. A ready first-week kit plus an India-packed starter suitcase is rare. **How it works:**

1. Parents order a pack based on the university and room type.
2. You order bedding and kitchen packs from a supplier in that country (UK, Canada, Australia) to reach the room before the student arrives.
3. In India, you pack a starter suitcase: a small pressure cooker, spice tins, pickles, plug adapters and vacuum-packed clothes.
4. Extra option: a 2-hour "cook 10 basic dishes" class by a home-chef partner before departure.

Who pays and how much: Parents of students starting courses in January or September. About ₹6,000–9,000 per kit, plus about ₹2,500 for the cooking class. **Proof it works abroad:** UniKitOut, UK: delivers bedding, kitchen and bathroom kits to student halls before students arrive, and universities such as LSE recommend it. **(source)** **Who does this in India now:** Two to three found: AmberStudent (sells a student essentials kit), Discounto (student kits) and Kalapurn Classes (a cooking course for students going abroad). **To start:** About ₹1,60,000 (starter stock, tie-ups with study-abroad consultants, ads). About 4 weeks; students starting in January leave in December–January. Main risk: AmberStudent is big and already sells kits, so compete on the India-packed suitcase and the cooking class.

76

Flying your parents in business class with your card points

An expert turns NRI children's credit-card and airline points into business-class tickets for their parents. **What's missing in India today:** Long flights are hard on older parents, and business class can cost several lakh rupees. Many NRIs, and Indians with premium credit cards, hold lots of points but don't know how to move them to airlines and find seats that can be bought with points. **How it works:**

1. The customer fills a form with travel dates, cities and the points they hold.
2. Your partner, a points expert from Indian points communities, finds seats that can be booked with points and the best way to move the points.
3. The customer moves the points and books, or the expert books with their permission.
4. You charge a fixed fee per passenger and make Reels like "Flew my parents business class to Toronto for almost no cash".

Who pays and how much: NRIs flying parents over or home, and Indians with premium cards. About ₹4,000–8,000 per passenger. **Proof it works abroad:** point.me, US: raised a \$15 million funding round in September 2024, co-led by Citi Ventures, for its points search and full-service points booking. **(source)** **Who does this in India now:** Three found: LiveFromALounge's points-booking service, Book1A and SaveSage. **To start:** About ₹60,000 (booking form, Reels, ads). About 2–3 weeks. Main risk: you depend on one expert's skill, and banks often change their points rules.

77

Checked drivers to take children to classes and activities

Checked, trained drivers take children to tuition, sports and hobby classes while parents track every ride. What's missing in India today: Working parents juggle office hours with children's evening classes across town. School vans only go to school, and parents don't trust ordinary cab drivers with a 9-year-old on their own. How it works:

1. Parents book fixed weekly rides on WhatsApp or a simple form.
2. You partner with a cab company or a few owner-drivers, and do police verification, background checks and child-safety training for every driver.
3. A woman attendant rides along with younger children, and parents get live location plus pick-up and drop-off photos.
4. You sell monthly packages through housing societies and activity academies.

Who pays and how much: Working parents in large gated societies. About ₹6,000–10,000 a month for 3 fixed rides a week. **Proof it works abroad:** HopSkipDrive, US: its checked "CareDrivers" have completed more than 5 million rides for more than 14,000 schools. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No Indian app found. Informal school vans and private drivers are the substitute. The US model is HopSkipDrive ([TechCrunch](#)). **To start:** About ₹1,00,000 (verification, training, insurance, ads). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: any incident with a child is very serious, so strict checks, attendants and live tracking are a must.

78

Fair sharing of parents' jewellery and keepsakes among siblings

A neutral helper lists a parent's belongings so siblings, including those abroad, can share them fairly by turns. What's missing in India today: When parents move to a smaller home or pass away, brothers and sisters, often living in different countries, must divide jewellery, sarees, furniture and photos. It causes hurt feelings and long fights, and families rarely have a neutral person to run the process. How it works:

1. The family books, and your partner visits the home to photograph and list every item, with a trusted valuer for gold.
2. You put the list, with photos, in a shared online sheet.
3. Siblings choose items by taking turns, or by "spending" an equal number of points, on a video call that you run, and you record every choice.
4. You arrange packing and shipping of each sibling's share. Parents can lead this while they are alive.

Who pays and how much: Siblings, especially NRIs. About ₹15,000–40,000 depending on the size of the home. **Proof it works abroad:** FairSplit, US: an online service that lists a home's belongings with photos and lets family members divide them by taking turns or bidding; it quotes an estate expert saying most families expect no conflict and most of them end up in one. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No friendly item-sharing service found. Lawyers and family mediators handle disputes after they start ([The Statesman](#)). **To start:** About ₹50,000 (valuer tie-up, templates, ads). About 4–6 weeks. Main risk: property and inheritance disputes, so handle only movable items and never give legal advice.

79

Letters from Santa posted to children

Children receive a personalised letter from Santa in the post, mentioning their name, friends and good deeds. What's missing in India today: Many city families now celebrate Christmas with their children, but the Santa magic is mostly a quick photo at a mall. Abroad, personalised Santa letters that arrive by post are a big Christmas business. How it works:

1. Parents fill an online form with the child's name, age, city, one good deed and one wish.
2. Your designer prints a letter on special paper with a "North Pole" stamp, a "Nice List" certificate and a small gift such as a sticker sheet.
3. You post or courier it to arrive between 10 and 24 December.
4. Extra option: a personalised video message from Santa, recorded by an actor partner.

Who pays and how much: Parents of children aged 3–9 in the metros, Goa, Kerala and the North-East. About ₹499–1,499 per pack. **Proof it works abroad:** Package From Santa, US: a family-owned company running for 20 years that sells Santa letter packs from \$9.95 to \$89.95 and says it has served millions of families. ([source](#)) **Who does this in India now:** No Indian service found; overseas sellers on Etsy are the substitute. **To start:** About ₹40,000 (design, paper, first 300 packs, ads). About 2–3 weeks, just in time for Christmas 2026. Main risk: it sells only in December, so plan a second product, such as birthday letters "from the Tooth Fairy".

Home, travel, hobbies and lifestyle

80

Live Christmas trees you rent and give back

A real, living Christmas tree in a pot is delivered in December and collected in January.

What's missing in India today: Families, cafés and offices that celebrate Christmas either buy a plastic tree or cut branches that dry out in days. No one we found rents a living tree that goes back to a nursery after the season.

How it works:

1. A customer picks a tree size (about 3, 5 or 7 feet) and a delivery date on your Instagram or website.
2. You book potted pine-type plants from a large nursery partner and plan the delivery routes.
3. The nursery's staff deliver and set up the tree, then collect it in the first week of January and look after it until next year.
4. You also rent lights and ornaments, and message the same customers again next November.

Who pays and how much: Families, cafés, offices, schools and small hotels. About ₹2,500 for a small tree and about ₹8,000 for a tall one, for about 4 weeks, with delivery and pickup.

Proof it works abroad: Rent A Living Christmas Tree, USA (California): delivers a potted Christmas tree to your door and picks it up after the holidays ([Time Out](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹60,000–₹1,00,000 (nursery advance for about 50 trees, plus Reels ads). About 2–3 weeks to the first paying customer, as bookings begin in late November. Main risk: it is one season a year, and some trees may die in dark flats.

81

Hot tubs delivered for winter house parties

A warm outdoor hot tub delivered, filled and taken away for a weekend party.

What's missing in India today: North Indian winters are cold, and people hosting farmhouse or rooftop parties want something special. Today the only way to get a hot tub is to book a villa that already has one.

How it works:

1. A customer books a tub for a weekend at a farmhouse, rooftop or bungalow garden.
2. You buy 2–3 blow-up (inflatable) hot tubs; a partner swimming-pool technician delivers, fills and heats one the day before.
3. After the party he drains, cleans and packs it.
4. You also rent towels, robes, fairy lights and floating drink trays.

Who pays and how much: People hosting winter birthdays, bachelorette parties, wedding after-parties, and farmhouse owners who rent to guests. About ₹8,000–₹15,000 for a weekend.

Proof it works abroad: Party Hire Stuff, UK: rents a 5-seater hot tub for £199 from Thursday to Monday; the Add to Event site lists 30+ UK hot-tub hire suppliers ([Add to Event](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Only villas on Airbnb that already have a hot tub came up.

To start: About ₹1,50,000 for 2 tubs, pumps, covers and ads. About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer (Delhi NCR winter). Main risk: the water takes about a day to heat and needs power; hygiene; it only sells in winter.

82

Paid visits to beautiful private gardens

Owners of lovely private gardens open them a few days a year, and visitors buy tickets.

What's missing in India today: Cities have beautiful private gardens, farmhouses and old bungalows that the public never sees. Garden lovers and families have few calm, green places to visit on winter weekends.

How it works:

1. You sign up garden owners (farmhouses, bungalows, estates near the city) to open 2–4 days a season.
2. Visitors book timed tickets online; a partner café runs a tea stall and a gardener gives a short walk.
3. You handle tickets, crowd limits, parking and a person at the gate.
4. You split the ticket money with the owner, or give their share to a charity they choose.

Who pays and how much: Garden lovers, families, retired people and photographers. About ₹300–₹600 a ticket.

Proof it works abroad: National Garden Scheme, UK: opens over 3,300 private gardens to paying visitors and has given over £77.8 million to nursing charities since 1927 ([NGS](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found. The UK's National Garden Scheme opens about 3,700 private gardens a year ([Country & Town House](#)).

To start: About ₹30,000–₹50,000. About 4–6 weeks to the first paying visitors (winter is garden season). Main risk: owners worry about privacy and damage.

83

Big suitcases on rent for one trip

Rent a large, good suitcase for one trip; it is delivered home and collected after.

What's missing in India today: Many families need a huge suitcase once a year (a foreign holiday, a wedding, a student moving abroad), then it sits under the bed. Shops only sell suitcases; we found luggage storage services, but no one renting suitcases.

How it works:

1. A customer picks a size and dates on your website or WhatsApp.
2. You buy a stock of strong suitcases in bulk from a luggage wholesaler.
3. A delivery partner drops the suitcase home before the trip and collects it after; a cleaning partner wipes and checks it.
4. You also sell luggage scales, covers and packing cubes, and offer "keep it" at a discount.

Who pays and how much: Families going abroad, students and wedding travellers. About ₹800–₹1,500 for up to 2 weeks, plus a refundable deposit.

Proof it works abroad: R&Y Rental, Japan: has more than 7,000 suitcases for rent and ships over 20,000 a month ([Japan Post case study](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search. Lugsto and SafeStorage store bags; they do not rent suitcases.

To start: About ₹1,20,000 for about 30–40 suitcases plus ads. About 2–3 weeks to the first paying customer (December holidays). Main risk: airline damage and slow payback.

84

Send your bags ahead so you travel hands-free

Your suitcases are picked up at home and delivered to your hotel, wedding venue or airport.

What's missing in India today: Families going to weddings or on holiday drag heavy bags through stations, airports and cabs. In Japan, sending bags ahead is normal; in India very few people know it is possible.

How it works:

1. A customer books a pickup online: from where, to where, how many bags.
2. You give the job to a courier partner (other city) or a local van partner (same city).
3. The bags are sealed, tracked and delivered before the guest arrives.
4. You sell group deals to wedding planners and resorts for all their guests.

Who pays and how much: Wedding guests, holiday families and older travellers. About ₹600–₹1,200 a bag within a city; more between cities.

Proof it works abroad: Yamato Transport, Japan: airport-to-city bag delivery costs about ¥1,700 a bag and usually arrives the same day by 5pm ([Japlaning](#))

Who does this in India now: CarterX (Bengaluru; moves bags to and from airports) and Baggage Free (Mumbai; ships bags ahead).

To start: About ₹30,000 (website, partner deals, ads). About 2–3 weeks to the first paying customer (wedding season). Main risk: lost or late bags; partners letting you down.

85

Fruit-picking day trips from the city

A bus trip to a farm where families pick strawberries, grapes or mangoes and take them home.

What's missing in India today: City children rarely see where fruit grows. A few farms allow picking, but families must find them, drive for hours and hope they are open.

How it works:

1. You partner with fruit farms that allow picking for a fixed fee (for example, strawberries near Mahabaleshwar for Pune and Mumbai; crops differ by city).
2. Families book seats online, and a bus partner picks them up early in the morning.
3. The farmer's team guides the picking, and a local caterer serves lunch.
4. Each family takes home a basket (about 1 kg included) and can pay for more.

Who pays and how much: Families with children, school groups and office teams. About ₹2,000–₹3,000 a person, including bus, picking and lunch.

Proof it works abroad: Pick-your-own farms, UK and USA (many small farms, not one company): pick-your-own strawberries started in the UK in 1961, and U-pick farms run in all 50 US states ([Wikipedia](#))

Who does this in India now: Some Mahabaleshwar farms (Laxmi Strawberry Farm, Green Valley Farm, Dhanashree Garden) let visitors pick, and Nine Tours sells a Pune day trip with optional strawberry picking. No city brand running regular picking trips was found.

To start: About ₹40,000–₹60,000 (bus advance, farm fees, ads). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer (strawberry season starts in winter). Main risk: weather and crop timing; long drives.

86

Overnight museum sleepovers for kids

Children spend a night inside a museum or science centre with torch-lit tours, a show and breakfast.

What's missing in India today: Indian museums close in the evening, and children's visits are short school trips. Parents looking for a special weekend treat have no "night at the museum" option.

How it works:

1. You sign up a private museum, science centre or planetarium that is empty at night and wants extra income.
2. With a partner events team you plan the night: torch tour, a science or history show, a craft, a film, sleeping mats and breakfast.
3. Parents book tickets online for a child plus one adult; the museum's staff and hired security run the night.
4. You fill places through Reels, schools and parents' WhatsApp groups, and share ticket money with the museum.

Who pays and how much: Parents of 7–12-year-olds. About ₹3,000–₹4,500 for a child and parent together.

Proof it works abroad: Natural History Museum, London, UK: its "Dino Snores" sleepovers for children aged 7 to 11 cost from £87 a person ([NHM](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹50,000–₹80,000 (mats, food partner, insurance, ads). About 4–6 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: getting a museum to say yes; child safety.

87

Fishing day trips with local boat owners

Book a half-day fishing trip with a local boat owner, with rods, bait and guidance included.

What's missing in India today: Fishing videos are popular, but beginners don't know where to go, whom to trust or what to bring. Local fishermen and lake boat owners have no easy way to take bookings online.

How it works:

1. You sign up boat owners and experienced anglers on the coast or at lakes near the city where fishing is allowed.
2. Customers book a trip online; you take payment and send directions, timing and a kit list.
3. The boat owner runs the trip and brings rods and bait.
4. You build a group: a monthly "catch and release" outing and a beginner kit to buy.

Who pays and how much: Hobbyists, groups of friends, parents with children, and office groups. About ₹2,000–₹4,000 a person for a half-day.

Proof it works abroad: FishingBooker, USA and Serbia: lists 62,909 fishing trips in 128 countries and has had over 1,000,000 trips completed, without outside investors ([FishingBooker](#))

Who does this in India now: A full search was not possible because the search limit ran out. FishingBooker itself lists only 9 trips in India, in the Andamans and the Himalayas, and none near the big cities ([FishingBooker India](#)).

To start: About ₹30,000. About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: fishing rules differ by place; safety on boats.

88

Rent a guitar or keyboard, and the rent counts toward buying it

Start lessons on a rented instrument; if you keep it, all the rent you paid counts toward the price.

What's missing in India today: Parents and adults hesitate to spend about ₹10,000–₹40,000 on an instrument for a hobby that may not last. Most music shops only sell.

How it works:

1. A customer picks an instrument (guitar, keyboard, ukulele or violin) and rents it monthly.
2. A partner music shop supplies the instruments and repairs them.
3. A delivery partner drops it home, and you connect the customer with a partner teacher for online or home lessons.
4. After 6–12 months the customer can return it or buy it, with all rent paid counted toward the price.

Who pays and how much: Parents of beginners and adult learners. About ₹500–₹1,500 a month.

Proof it works abroad: Music & Arts, USA: counts 100% of rental payments toward buying the instrument and serves 300,000+ parents through about 250 locations ([Music & Arts](#))

Who does this in India now: 2: Rentock (Mumbai) rents instruments online ([Gust](#)), and local shops such as OMR Musical (Chennai) rent and sell. No rent-to-own plan found.

To start: About ₹1,00,000, or much less if the music shop owns the stock and you split the money. About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: damaged instruments; people quitting after two months.

89

Video calls from Santa for your child

Your child gets a personal video or live video call from Santa, who knows their name and wishes.

What's missing in India today: Christmas is a big event for children in Indian cities and schools, but Santa only appears at mall events. Parents have no way to give their child a personal "Santa knows me" moment.

How it works:

1. Parents fill a form: the child's name, age, friends, something they did well, and a wish.
2. A partner actor in a good Santa costume records a personal video or does a 5-minute live video call at a booked time.
3. A freelance editor adds music and the child's photos.
4. You sell class packages to schools and play schools.

Who pays and how much: Parents of 3–9-year-olds. About ₹499 for a recorded video and about ₹1,499 for a live call.

Proof it works abroad: Portable North Pole (home country not checked): has made personalised Santa videos and calls since 2008, with over 354 million video views ([Portable North Pole](#))

Who does this in India now: No Indian live-Santa service found. Global apps like Portable North Pole are the substitute (PNP).

To start: About ₹25,000 (costume, simple set, actor fees, ads). About 2 weeks to the first paying customer (December). Main risk: the season is only about 4–5 weeks; the actor must be good.

90

Kids' bicycles on a monthly plan that grow with your child

Rent your child a bicycle by the month, and swap it for a bigger one when they grow.

What's missing in India today: Children outgrow a cycle every year or two, so parents keep buying new ones while the old ones rust in the parking. Only one company does this, and only in Bengaluru.

How it works:

1. A parent picks a cycle size online and pays a monthly fee plus a small deposit.
2. You buy a small stock of good cycles at a bulk price through a local cycle-shop partner.
3. The cycle shop delivers, services the cycle every few months, and swaps it for the next size when asked.
4. Returned cycles are cleaned, fixed by the shop and rented out again.

Who pays and how much: Parents of 3–12-year-olds in housing societies. About ₹300–₹600 a month, plus a refundable deposit of about ₹1,500.

Proof it works abroad: The Bike Club, UK: had a fleet of over 20,000 kids' bikes in January 2021, from £5 a month ([BikeBiz](#))

Who does this in India now: 1: Gro Club in Bengaluru rents bicycles to kids and adults with doorstep delivery and repairs ([Dealroom](#)).

To start: About ₹1,50,000 for about 25 cycles plus ads. About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: money is tied up in cycles and comes back slowly; damage and theft.

91

Learn-to-ride bicycle camps for kids

A short weekend course where a coach teaches young children to ride a bicycle confidently.

What's missing in India today: Busy parents struggle to teach their children to cycle, and many kids give up after a few falls. There is rarely a simple, bookable course run by trained coaches near home.

How it works:

1. You book a safe open space (a society ground, school ground or park) for weekend mornings.
2. Parents book a 3–4 session course online for children aged about 4–8.
3. Partner coaches teach balance first, then pedalling and braking, using balance bikes and cycles you provide.
4. You also sell helmets and next-level road-safety sessions, and send happy parents to your other cycle ideas.

Who pays and how much: Parents of 4–8-year-olds. About ₹2,500–₹3,500 for a 4-session course.

Proof it works abroad: Pedalheads, Canada and USA: has run bike camps and lessons since 1986 at 400+ locations, with over 700,000 children taught life skills ([Pedalheads](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹50,000 (10 balance bikes, helmets, coach fees, ads). About 2–3 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: child injuries; getting free ground space.

92

Buy, sell and trade used sports gear

A shop and website where you sell your old sports gear and buy good used gear cheaply.

What's missing in India today: Children outgrow cricket kits, skates, football boots and rackets fast, and adults give up gym or golf. Good gear sits at home because selling it piece by piece online is a hassle.

How it works:

1. People drop off gear or send photos; you pay cash or give store credit.
2. A partner sports-shop technician cleans, restrings or fixes items.
3. You sell online, through Reels, and at weekend stalls at sports academies and turfs.
4. You offer "trade up": bring the small size and pay the difference for the next size.

Who pays and how much: Parents of young players and beginners in a new sport. Items about ₹300–₹10,000; you keep about 30–40% of the price.

Proof it works abroad: Play It Again Sports, USA: a chain of locally owned shops that has bought, sold and traded used sports gear for over 40 years ([Play It Again Sports](#))

Who does this in India now: 1–2: Sports Galaxy (online trade-in store since 2019) ([Sports Galaxy](#)), and general listings on OLX.

To start: About ₹60,000–₹1,00,000 (first stock and stall costs). About 2–3 weeks to the first sale. Main risk: stock that doesn't sell; hygiene worries about pads and helmets.

93

Track days for everyday car and bike owners

Ordinary people drive their own car or ride their own bike on a real racetrack, with coaching.

What's missing in India today: Many people own fast cars and bikes but have nowhere legal to drive fast, so some race on highways. Circuits do sell track time, but few people know how to book it, what to bring or where to get coaching.

How it works:

1. You book places at a circuit's open track day (for example, the Buddh circuit near Delhi).
2. Customers buy a package: track time, a session with a partner racing instructor, helmet hire, photos and video, and lunch.
3. You run the group on the day: safety briefing, timings, a WhatsApp group and a lap-time leaderboard.
4. You grow it into a club with regular events and Reels from each day.

Who pays and how much: Car and bike fans aged about 22–45. About ₹8,000–₹15,000 for a car package and about ₹5,000–₹8,000 for a bike.

Proof it works abroad: Hooked On Driving, USA: runs track days for ordinary car owners in five US regions, with coaches, and welcomes first-timers ([Hooked On Driving](#))

Who does this in India now: Buddh International Circuit runs its own open track days (₹6,500 for a 30-minute car session in 2019, per [evo India](#)). No separate organiser was found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹50,000–₹80,000 (track booking advance, coach fees, ads). About 4–6 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: crashes and insurance; few circuits outside Delhi NCR and Tamil Nadu.

94

Battery health check before you buy a used electric car or scooter

A technician plugs a reader into a used electric vehicle and gives you a report on its battery health.

What's missing in India today: The battery is the most expensive part of an electric car, and a test drive cannot show how worn it is. India has no common standard for this, so buyers mostly trust the seller's word.

How it works:

1. A buyer (or a seller who wants to prove the car is good) books a check online.
2. You send a partner EV technician with a tool that plugs into the vehicle's diagnostic socket.
3. The tool reads how much charge the battery can still hold; you send a simple one-page report with a "fair price" note.
4. You also sell checks to small used-car dealers.

Who pays and how much: Used EV buyers, sellers and small dealers. About ₹1,500 for a scooter and about ₹3,000–₹4,000 for a car.

Proof it works abroad: Aviloo, Austria: its three-minute battery test covers 96% of EV models on the road, and in 2026 it extended a used-EV battery warranty based on this test to 10 European countries ([Bestmag](#))

Who does this in India now: [ev.care](#) (active in Delhi) and VahanBazaar's AI Vahan Inspection offer doorstep battery checks ([ev.care](#)). Spinny and Cars24 check only the cars they sell.

To start: About ₹40,000–₹60,000 (a good reading tool, technician fees, listings). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: the tool may not read every brand; few used EVs in some cities.

95

Car-boot sale markets

A Sunday-morning market where families sell their old things straight from their car boots.

What's missing in India today: Homes are full of good unused things (books, toys, kitchenware, gadgets), but selling online means endless chats, bargaining and no-shows. India has flea markets for traders, but we found no regular market where ordinary families sell from their own cars.

How it works:

1. You rent a large parking lot (a mall, school, club or society ground) for one or two Sunday mornings a month.
2. Sellers book a car spot online and pay a fee; buyers walk in free or pay a small ticket.
3. Partners run food stalls, music and a kids' corner; hired staff manage parking.
4. You fill the market through Reels and society WhatsApp groups, and sell banners to local brands.

Who pays and how much: Families clearing out their homes (about ₹500–₹1,000 a car spot), food stalls (about ₹1,500–₹3,000) and local sponsors.

Proof it works abroad: Global Village, Dubai, UAE: ran a weekly car-boot sale where sellers paid Dh150 for a spot and buyers entered free ([Gulf News, 2018](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found in a quick search.

To start: About ₹40,000–₹70,000 for the first market (ground rent, permissions, signs, ads). About 3–4 weeks to the first paying sellers. Main risk: getting a cheap ground and police or venue permission; too few sellers at the first event.

96

Rooftop tents for your own SUV, rented by the weekend

A tent fitted on top of your own car for a weekend, so you can camp almost anywhere.

What's missing in India today: More people own SUVs like the Thar and Jimny and love road trips, but a rooftop tent is expensive to buy. You can rent a whole campervan or a ground tent, but not a rooftop tent for your own car.

How it works:

1. A customer picks dates and tells you the car model.
2. You buy 2–3 rooftop tents, or tie up with a rooftop-tent seller who lends stock and splits the money.
3. A partner fitter mounts the tent on Friday and removes it on Monday.
4. You also rent camping kits (mattress, lights, stove) and share safe camping spots.

Who pays and how much: SUV owners aged about 25–45. About ₹3,000–₹5,000 a night, minimum 2 nights.

Proof it works abroad: Rooftop-tent hire shops in Australia and the UK (not checked).

Who does this in India now: Camping Co (Guwahati) rents Thars and Xenons that come with rooftop tents ([Responsible Tourism India](#)); campervan firms such as Motorhome Adventures rent whole vans; Renta.in rents ground tents. No one found renting a rooftop tent for your own car.

To start: About ₹1,50,000–₹2,00,000 if you buy 2 tents, or about ₹40,000 if a seller lends stock. About 4 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: tents don't fit every car's roof; damage.

97

Checked second-hand premium cycles and e-cycles with a warranty

Buy a used premium bicycle or e-cycle that has been checked, fixed and comes with a 6-month warranty.

What's missing in India today: Many people buy costly cycles and e-cycles, ride them for a few months, then leave them unused. Buyers on OLX fear hidden faults and stolen cycles, so good used cycles don't sell easily.

How it works:

1. Owners send photos; you offer a price and buy the cycle, or list it for them and take a share when it sells.
2. A partner cycle mechanic checks and fixes it (brakes, gears, and the battery on e-cycles), and you photograph it.
3. You sell it online and on Instagram with a 6-month warranty and home delivery.
4. Later you offer trade-ins: bring your old cycle and pay the difference for a better one.

Who pays and how much: Office commuters, fitness riders and students. About ₹8,000–₹40,000 a cycle; you keep about ₹2,000–₹6,000 on each.

Proof it works abroad: Upway, France and USA: has refurbished and sold over 100,000 e-bikes, usually about 45% below the new price, with a one-year warranty ([Tech.eu](#))

Who does this in India now: No one found for bicycles in a quick search. CredR sells checked second-hand motorbikes and scooters, not cycles.

To start: About ₹1,00,000–₹1,50,000 for the first 10–15 cycles, or close to nothing if you start by listing cycles for owners. About 3–4 weeks to the first sale. Main risk: being sold stolen cycles; slow sales.

98

A bicycle repair van that comes to your home or office

A mechanic comes to your society parking or office and services your bicycle or e-cycle on the spot.

What's missing in India today: Cycle shops are often far away and you need a car to carry the cycle there, so cycles sit with flat tyres and rusty chains. E-cycle owners find it especially hard to get someone who understands their cycle.

How it works:

1. Customers book a service slot online; you group bookings so the mechanic visits one society or office for several cycles at once.
2. A partner mechanic with a small van or cargo vehicle full of tools does the service on the spot.
3. You sell yearly service plans and spare parts.
4. You set up "cycle service days" with housing societies and offices.

Who pays and how much: Cycle owners, parents of young riders, office cyclists and e-cycle owners. About ₹499–₹999 a service.

Proof it works abroad: Velofix, Canada and USA: mobile bike shops with 130+ certified technicians and over 220,000 services done ([Velofix](#))

Who does this in India now: 1: Fix My Cycle (Chennai) books doorstep bicycle repairs in about 20 cities ([YourStory](#)).

To start: About ₹50,000 (tools, parts, ads; the mechanic uses his own vehicle at first). About 2–3 weeks to the first paying customer. Main risk: low money per job; finding a reliable mechanic.

99

Washable cups for events instead of plastic

You bring washable cups to events, collect them afterwards and get them washed, so no plastic cups are used.

What's missing in India today: Concerts, marathons, festivals and society events throw away thousands of plastic and paper cups. Organisers want to look green but don't have time to manage reusable cups themselves.

How it works:

1. An event organiser books cups for a date; you bring branded hard cups in crates.
2. Guests pay a small deposit with their first drink and get it back when they return the cup, or keep the cup.
3. A commercial dishwashing partner collects the dirty crates and washes them for the next event.
4. You sell the event's sponsor a logo printed on the cups.

Who pays and how much: Event organisers, breweries, marathon organisers and companies holding events. About ₹8–₹15 a cup per use, plus guest deposits.

Proof it works abroad: RECUP, Germany: its deposit cups are used at around 20,000 places across Germany, with a €1 deposit a cup ([RECUP](#))

Who does this in India now: Recube, Mumbai (brand Cupable): supplies reusable cups to 500+ food outlets and has been used at 150+ events ([Eco-Business](#)).

To start: About ₹1,00,000 (about 3,000 cups, crates, ads). About 4 weeks to the first paying customer (December events). Main risk: cups going missing; organisers choosing cheap plastic instead.

100

Rent a whole fruit tree and get all its fruit

Book one apple, orange or litchi tree on a farm for a season and get all its fruit delivered.

What's missing in India today: People want fresh, naturally ripened fruit and to know who grew it. One startup does this for mangoes, but other fruits have no such option.

How it works:

1. You sign up a few orchards (for example, apples in Himachal or oranges near Nagpur), and the farmer tags and photographs each tree.
2. Customers choose a tree online, pay for the season, and get photo and video updates from the farm.
3. At harvest the farmer picks and packs the fruit, and a courier partner delivers it in 2–3 boxes.
4. You sell "a tree in your name" as a birthday or Diwali gift.

Who pays and how much: City families and gift buyers. About ₹6,000–₹12,000 a tree for a season (about 20–40 kg of fruit).

Proof it works abroad: Nudo Adopt, Italy: people adopt an olive tree from small farmers and receive its olive oil by post every few months; it marked its 20th anniversary in 2025 ([Nudo Adopt](#))

Who does this in India now: Rent a Tree (Kochi) rents Alphonso mango trees from about ₹10,300 a season and had about 160 customers in March 2026 ([FreshPlaza](#)). It only does mangoes.

To start: About ₹50,000 (farm visits, tagging, photos, website, ads). About 4–6 weeks to the first paying customer (sell before each harvest). Main risk: bad weather cuts the crop; fruit damaged in transit.